

What will I learn?**10.1 Reading Comprehension**

- Use pre-reading strategies to predict the content of a text from topic/picture, title/headings, key words and visuals etc. by using prior knowledge, asking questions and contextual clues.
- Read silently and apply critical thinking to interact with the text, using intensive reading strategies (while-reading) to:
 - Make simple inferences using context of the text and prior knowledge.
 - Distinguish between what is clearly stated and what is implied.
 - Deduce meaning of difficult new words/phrases from context.
 - Comprehend/interpret text by applying critical thinking.
- Respond orally and in writing to the text to:
 - give a personal opinion and justify stance related to viewpoints/ ideas and issues in the text read.
 - relate what is read to his or her own feelings and experiences.
 - evaluate the material read.

10.2 Writing

- Proofread and edit own and peers' work for errors of usage and style.

10.3 Oral Communication

- Listen attentively and respond accordingly.

10.4 Grammar

- Illustrate the use of both active and passive voices in various writing tasks (letter, report, descriptive essay).
- Use correct vocabulary in speech and writing, and use correct spelling in writing.

10.1 READING COMPREHENSION

Pre-reading

1. What comes in your mind after reading following quotations given in the bubbles?

"Patience accomplishes its object, while hurry speeds to its ruin."
(Saadi)

"Desires make slaves out of kings and patience makes kings out of slaves."
(Al-Ghazali)

"Yesterday, I was clever, so I wanted to change the world. Today, I am wise, so I am changing myself."
(Rumi)

"Independence is of more value than any gifts; and to receive gifts is to lose it."
(Saadi)

"Raise your words, not voice. It is rain that grows flowers, not thunder."
(Rumi)

Reading texts

Pearls of Wisdom
(Shaikh Saadi)

(Text-I)

There were two brothers, one of them in the service of the sultan and the other gaining his livelihood by the effort of his arm. The wealthy man once asked his destitute brother why he did not serve the sultan in order to be delivered from the hardship of labouring. He replied, 'why labourest thou not to be delivered from the baseness of service because wise men have said that it is better to eat barley bread and to sit than to gird oneself with a golden belt and to stand in service?'

To leaven mortar of quicklime with the hand

Is better than to hold them on the breast before the Amir.

My precious life was spent in considering what I am to eat in summer
and wear in winter.

O' ignoble belly, be satisfied with one bread

Rather than to bend the back in service.

Note for Teacher: Ask the students to write individually. If any student did not write anything, ask him/her to remain calm and listen to others. Tell following quotes to the students and ask them to guess the topic of lesson. Also, encourage students to form quotes from previous lesson.

(Text-II)

A king was in the same boat with a slave who had never before been at sea and experienced the inconvenience of a vessel. He began to cry and to tremble to such a degree that he could not be pacified by kindness, so that at last the king became displeased as the matter could not be remedied. In that boat, there happened to be a wise man, who said, 'with thy permission, I shall quiet him.' The king replied, 'it will be a great favour.' The wise man ordered the slave to be thrown into the water so that he swallowed some of it, whereon he was caught and pulled by his hair to the boat, to the stern of which he clung with both his hands. Then, he sat down in a corner and became quiet. This appeared strange to the king who knew nothing what wisdom there was in the proceeding and asked for it. The wise man replied, 'before he had tasted the calamity of being drowned, he knew not the safety of the boat; thus also a man does not appreciate the value of immunity from a misfortune, until it has befallen him.'

(Text-III)

I noticed an Arab of the desert sitting in a company of jewellers at Basrah and narrating stories to them. He said, 'I had once lost my road in the desert and consumed all my provisions. I considered that I must perish when I suddenly caught sight of a bag. I shall never forget the joy and ecstasy I felt on thinking they might be parched grain and food nor the bitterness and despair when I discovered them to be pearls.'

In a dry desert and among moving sand,
It is the same to a thirsty man whether he has pearls or shells in his mouth.

When a man has no provisions and his
strength is exhausted,
It matters not whether his girdle is adorned
with pearls or potsherds.

(Text-IV)

A sage, instructing students, said to them "Learn a skill because property and riches of the world are not to be relied upon; also silver and gold are an occasion of danger because either a thief may steal them at once or the owner spend them gradually; but a profession is a living fountain and permanent wealth; and although a professional man may lose riches, it does not matter because a profession is itself wealth and wherever he goes he will enjoy respect and sit in high places, whereas he who has no skill will glean crumbs and see hardships.

(Text-V)

I heard a wise man saying that no one has ever made a confession of his own folly except he who begins speaking, whilst another has not yet finished his talk.

Words have a head, O shrewd man, and a tail. Do not insert thy words between words of others. The possessor of deliberation, intelligence and shrewdness does not say a word till he sees silence.

Maxims

Property is for the comfort of life, not for the accumulation of wealth. A sage, having been asked who is lucky and who is not, replied, "he is lucky who has eaten and sowed but he is unlucky who has died and not enjoyed."

It is contrary to what is proper, and against the opinion of to partake of medicine by guess and to go after a caravan without seeing the road. The Imam Muhammad Ghazali, upon whom be the mercy of Allah, having been asked in what manner he had attained such a degree of knowledge, replied, 'by not being ashamed to ask about things I did not know.'

A weak man trying to show his prowess off against a strong one only aids his foe to encompass his own destruction.

Even after falling into mud, a jewel retains its costliness, and dust. Although, it may rise into the sky, is as contemptible as before. Capacity without education is deplorable and education without capacity is thrown away.

Drop upon drop collected will make a river. Rivers upon rivers collected will make a sea. Little and little together will become much. The granary is but grain upon grain.

Confide not to a friend every secret thou possess. How know you that he will not some time become thy foe? Inflict not every injury you can upon an enemy because it is possible that one day he may become thy friend.

While-reading

Exercise 1

Work in pairs and find out the words from the text and match with their corresponding descriptions. After you have completed, share your work with your partner.

No.	Description	Words
1	extremely poor and lacking the means to provide for oneself	
2	shaking slightly in a way that one cannot control	
3	bringing or restoring to a state of peace or tranquillity	
4	happening especially as if by fate	
5	stimulating drug that can cause illusions	
6	decorated or beautified, as by ornaments	
7	the quality of having or showing good powers of judgement	
8	becoming involved with or take part in something	
9	skill or expertise in a particular activity or field	
10	repository for grain, especially after it has been threshed	

Exercise 2

Work individually. Read each text and suggest the appropriate title by writing before each text number. After you have completed, share your work with your class fellows.

NO.	Text No.	Suggested title
1	Text-I	
2	Text-II	
3	Text-III	
4	Text-IV	
5	Text-V	

Exercise 3

Read the statements and encircle the correct option.

1. The second brother was living by _____.
a) serving sultan b) doing Govt. service
c) doing labour d) selling belts
2. _____ said that it is better to eat barley than to gird with golden belts.
a) elder brother b) sultan
c) wealthy man d) servant
3. "To gird with golden belts", this phrase indicates to live _____.
a) hard life b) healthy life
c) wealthy life d) slavery life
4. The _____ was fearful during travel in the vessel.
a) king b) sultan
c) slave d) Wiseman
5. The slave was thrown in the sea to _____.
a) catch fish b) gain experience
c) go drowning d) save boat
6. The Arab became happy after _____.
a) finding bag b) gaining grain
c) finding water d) seeing pearls
7. The sage gave advice to his student that _____.
a) property can be made b) silver and gold are necessary
c) riches can be relied d) profession is wealth
8. "Little drops make an ocean." This proverb is appropriately depicted in _____.
a) Text-I b) Text-III
c) Maxim-V d) Maxim-III
9. A group of people travelling together is called as _____.
a) sages b) caravan
c) crew d) shrewd men
10. _____ may be the suitable message of text-II.
a) 'Self-done is well done,' b) 'Brave deeds need no show,'
c) 'Small wit great boast,' d) 'Silent water run deep,'

Post-reading

Exercise 4

Read the texts and answers the following questions.

1. What did the wealthy man ask the poor brother and what was his reply?
2. Why could the slave not be pacified even though he was in the same boat with the king?
3. What did the wise man do to make the slave realize about the security of boat?
4. What kind of virtue the sage wanted to teach to his students?
5. How does the professional man earn respect according to the sage?
6. Who is lucky and unlucky according to the maxim?
7. Confide not to a friend every secret thou possess. How know you that he will not some time become thy foe? How far do you agree and why?
8. Identify the maxim which reflects the value of real thing never fades or shatters.
9. What kind of suggestion did Imam Ghazali give to the people?
10. Which tale from the above texts do you like the most? And why?

Exercise 5

Work in pairs and write the concise central theme against each text. After you have completed, share your work with your partner.

No.	Text	Central Theme
1	Text-I	
2	Text-II	
3	Text-III	
4	Text-IV	
5	Text-V	

Note for teacher: Ask students to go back and read the texts again before doing Exercise 5. After they have done, tell them to exchange their work with each other after writing short paragraphs.

10.2 WRITING

Proofreading (Finishing Touch)

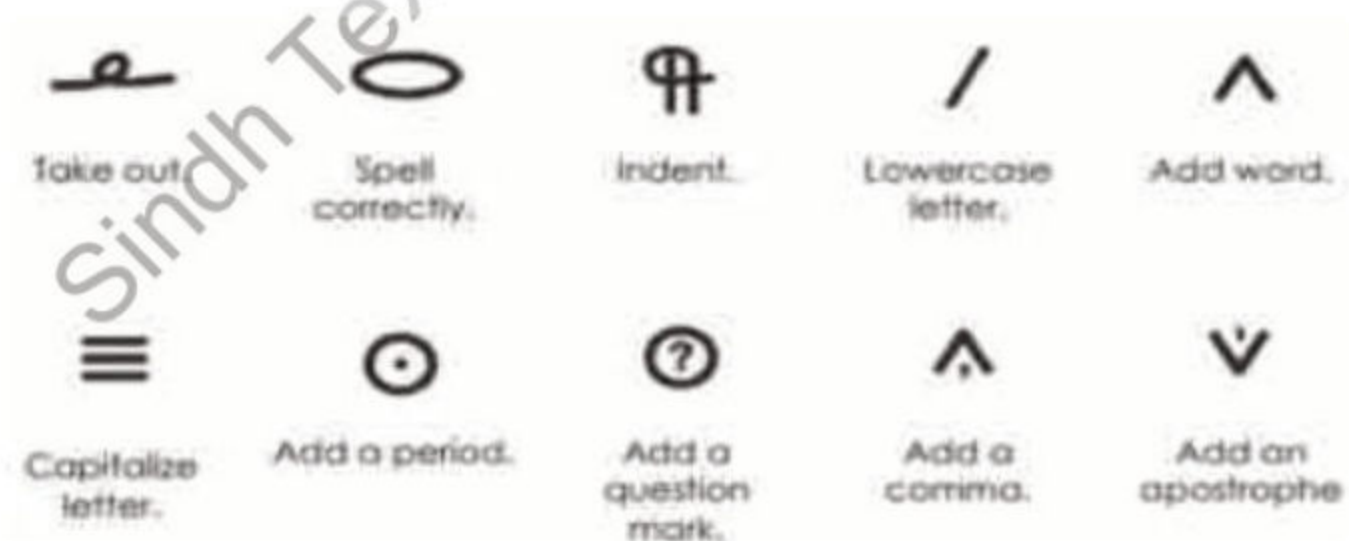
It is known as the very last step in writing process. The proofreading involves identifying and correcting the typographical mistakes in sentence structure, capitalization, spelling, grammar, punctuation, style, and formatting. Proofreading is the fundamental part of the revision process and its main objective is to ensure that the written document is perfect in terms of vocabulary and grammar.

Why is proofreading done?

Proofreading is very important because it is the last chance to find and fix errors before a document is presented to readers. Moreover, the proofreading eliminates mistakes in grammar, punctuation, capitalization, spelling, and formatting. It allows us to communicate our message accurately and effectively.

Proofreading Tips and Symbols

- Use a printed out paper for proofreading.
- Read the paper loudly.
- Read paper slowly line by line and word by word.
- Look for one type of error at a time.
- Circle punctuation marks.



Note for teacher: Briefly, explain the symbols of proofreading before class. Walk around to see if the students have understood the correct use of symbols.

Exercise 1

Write at least two sentences about each of the following topics in your notebook. Then, exchange your notebooks with your classmates to proofread. After you have completed, exchange your notebook with any of your class mates. Read each other's work and give feedback. Make changes in your work if needed.

Write what you say about.....

1. Getting education is _____
2. Your reaction to the food in college canteen _____
3. Elders must be respected because _____
4. Early to bed, early to rise, makes man healthy, wealthy and wise _____
5. Never, never, never give up _____

Exercise 2

Work individually and proofread the following letter by following the key tips provided above. After you have completed, compare your proofreading work with your partner.

with the invention of the personal computer and the Internet, a new age in communications begins. now people could communicate fastest and more easily than ever before. Writting, editing, and storing information became quick and easy. It was no longest necessary to write draft after draft when changes could be made so easily using a word Processor program. Messages, could now be sende in no time to anywhere in the world, without addressing envelopes or licking stamps. Century most early, around the year 1450 a similar revolution in communications had occurred in the Germany. This happened when johannes gutenbergr invented the printing press. he was not the first person to use printing to copy a peace of writing. printing was already being invented in the China, where they used clay to print oriental characters. Small items, such as posters and flyers, were already being printed in Europe too, using the woodblock method of printing. Books and other largest works were still being copied by hand. At this time, books were usually produced only in latin, and only the most educated people read them. Gutenbergs printing press was about to change all of this.

Note for teacher: After the students have completed and compared with their partner, get exercise solved on the blackboard.

10.3 ORAL COMMUNICATION

Listen Carefully and Respond Accordingly

Listening carefully and responding accordingly is one of the most important skills. You can respond accurately only when you listen attentively. In this way, you can improve your communication skills. Conversations are active, not passive. A conversation between people cannot occur without a response. Hence, active listening requires careful responses which are made possible with comprehending properly. An active response should show that you understand what the other person has said and have paid attention to their words.

Tips for listening attentively	Tips for responding accordingly
1. Pay attention. 2. Show that you're listening. 3. Provide feedback. 4. Defer judgment. 5. Respond appropriately.	1. Be candid, open and honest in your response. 2. Assert your opinions respectfully. 3. Treat the other person in a way that you think they would want to be treated.

Exercise 1

Look at the following sets of conversations and identify active listener and the one who responds properly.

Set A

- Ahmed:** I'm just really stressed about work at the moment.
Kinza: Me too, you wouldn't believe what one of my co-workers did yesterday.
Ahmed: And it's hard for me to pay enough attention to the kids when I have this much on my plate and just want to relax when I get home.
Kinza: Seriously, what she did was ridiculous.
Ahmed: What did she do?

Set B

Ahmed: I'm just really stressed about work at the moment.

Kinza: Why is it more stressful than usual right now?

Ahmed: Well, one of the people in my team is on holiday for a couple of weeks and I keep getting landed with their usual responsibilities.

Kinza: Have you spoken to your boss about that? You shouldn't be doing someone else's job as well as your own.

Exercise 2

Now, work in groups of two and discuss the following topics keeping above tips in the mind.

Turn by turn, each student should make a simple statement about the following. One of the others should respond accurately to each other.

1. Two students discussing each other on pros and cons of the social media.
2. Two friends asking each other's opinion about equality of all before law.

Note for teacher: Divide the class in groups of two and ask them to use tips in their practice at least three times by each student. Make sure that they use correct pronunciation and intonation. You can ask some students to role play their dialogues in front of class.

10.4 : GRAMMAR

a. Active Voice and Passive Voice

You have already learnt in detail about active voice and passive voice in your previous classes. Let us revise some of its rules.

Active Voice	Passive Voice
When an action performed by the subject is expressed by the verb, it is known as an active voice. Active voice is used when more straightforward relation and clarity is required between the subject and the verb. For example: Hens lay eggs. Birds build nests	When the action expressed by the verb is received by the subject, it is known as passive voice. Passive voice is used when the doer of the action is not known and the focus of the sentence is on the action and not the subject. For example: Eggs are laid by hens. Nests are built by birds.

Active and Passive Voice Rules for Conversion of Sentence

Below are the active-passive voice rules to follow for changing an active sentence into a passive voice.

Tense or Modal + Base	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Simple Present	beat / beats	am/is/are beaten
Past	beat	was / were beaten
Future	shall/will beat	shall /will be beaten
Continuous		
Present	am/is/are beating	am/is/are being beaten
Past	was/were beating	was/were being beaten
Future	shall/will be beating	Not applicable
Perfect		
Present	have/has beaten	have/has been beaten
Past	had beaten	had been beaten
Future	shall/will have beaten	shall/will have been beaten
Perfect Continuous		
Present		
Past	Not applicable	Not applicable
Future		
Can/may/must, etc + base	can/may/must, etc beat	can/may/must, etc be beaten.

Note: With conversion of Active Voice sentence into Passive Voice sentence, the pronoun used in the sentence also changes in the following manner.

Active Voice Noun	Passive Voice Noun
I	Me
We	Us
He	Him
She	Her
They	Them
You	You
It	It

Exercise 1

Given below is a sample of brief synopsis of a research report. It is written in active voice. Work in pairs and change the following from active voice into passive voice. After you have completed, share your work with your partner.

In this research, I administered a research survey. I created a compelling sample of 100 scientists. I invited them to participate in the survey by sending them an invite through emails. I received e-mail addresses from different research centres of the country.

Exercise 2

Given below is a sample of newspaper report. It is written in passive voice. Work individually and change the following from passive voice into active voice. Then, write the same in your notebook.

A bus has been stolen from outside the school. The thief was seen by some children. The bus is being searched by the police now. Children's descriptions will be used by them to catch the thief.

Note for teacher: Revise the previously learnt rules of active and passive voice.

Exercise 3

Work in pairs and change the voice of the following sentences. Rewrite the sentences in your notebook and share your work with your partner.

1. Don't touch the naked wire.
2. There is nothing to say.
3. He has to purchase a car.
4. One should listen to one's conscience.
5. I like the people to respect me.
6. Turn him out.
7. Someone killed the criminal.
8. It is time to switch off T.V.
9. I am to take tea.
10. Please bring me a glass of water.
11. Let her write a poem.
12. Did you tell a lie?
13. Why did you help her?
14. The judge enquired in to the case.
15. She made me sing.

Vocabulary and Spelling

Exercise 4

Work in pairs and use words given below to complete the following text. After you have completed, share your work with your partner.

resembles, wilderness, purpose, findings, valley, strangest, construction, political, pending, inhabitants, mystery, unclear, archaeologists, believed, vastness, located

The historic Rani Kot Fort is a _____. It was built on mountains of the Khirthar Ranges of Sindh. It is _____ about 28 kilometres from the Sann Gate from Jamshoro City. It is _____ to be the largest fort in the world having walls nearly 35 kilometres long. The age of the fort is _____, however, _____ predict that the magnificent structure was built sometime in the 9th-century. Visually, its walls are truly a roller coaster ride, sometimes going as high as three thousand feet above sea level while other times instantly sliding down towards the ground.

Archaeologists want to ensure Rani Kot Fort gets the recognition it deserves. Its _____ resembles the Great Wall of China which is why it is often referred to as "The Great Wall of Sindh." Since 1993, it has been on the tentative list to be designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site. Its status is still _____. Many agree that it is the most fascinating place in Sindh.

The surrounding walls of Rani Kot Fort are made from gypsum and lime cut sandstone.

To give you an idea of the _____ of Rani Kot Fort, it is so large that there is enough space in it for building hundreds of other forts.

It has been determined that Rani Kot Fort was built for the _____ of defence and to house many _____. The rulers of different times lived here and it was the center of _____ activities where many ancient leaders of Sindh gathered. Artefacts uncovered at Rani Kot tell a fascinating story of its inhabitants and a rich history that spans thousands of years. Some of the _____ include archaic coins, terracotta of the Indus Civilization, an engraved sign of a swastika, a leaf of the papal tree (sacred fig); evidence of a peacock, sunflower, and lotus flower; remains of Zoroastrians and Buddhists, and arrows of different kinds.

The entire fort is surrounded by hills that form a small _____ through which a stream passes. Its name is taken from this stream; "Rani" meaning Stream.

The Rani Kot Fort _____ no other fort in the world. Its unusual size, lost history, strategically useless position, uninhabited area, and unexplored features make the fort one of the _____ places in the world. One would require a time machine to solve its mystery. Its unusual size and location in the absolute _____ doesn't make sense, at least in the present times.

Exercise 5

Work in pairs and correct the spelling mistakes in the paragraph below. After you have completed, share your work with your partner.

Food directly affects your physical and emotional health. If you eat non-nutritious junk food and do not pay attention to your diet, then you pay the price of poor health or become severely overweight. If you eat good food and control what you eat, your chances of being healthy are much better. The place to begin a healthy lifestyle is in your choice of food, that is in your diet. I believe, a diet is a plan for eating. A well-balanced diet provides all of the energy you need to keep active throughout the day. It also gives you the nutrients you need for growth and repair, helping you to stay strong and healthy and help to prevent diet-related illness, such as some cancers.

Exercise 6

Work individually. In each of the groups of words below, one word may be misspelt or no words may be misspelled. If a word is misspelled, write it correctly to the right of each group. If none of the words in the group is misspelled, write "none."

1. fuzzes, laundrys, sufficient	
2. turkeys, trophies, arrival, armies	
3. acrage, analysis, dosage	
4. accompaniment, played, interviewed	
5. privilege, excelling, eighth	
6. adolescence, contemporary, ninty	
7. athletic, conscious, mathmatics	
8. performance, fiery, recede	
9. leisure, familiar, proffessor	
10. undoubtly, experience, succeed	
11. seize, acceptance, grammer	
12. pleasant, slyly, watches	
13. accidentally, embarass, intelligence	
14. prejudice, preferred, lieutenant	
15. payed, characteristic, intelligence, attendant	
16. sergeant, noticable, deceit	
17. particuler, arbitrarily, attorneys	
18. neither, acknowledge, goverment	
19. permmit, referring, foreign	
20. halves, accross,	
21. subtle, judgement, ancient	
22. said, envirement, interest	
23. realize, alleys, acheive	
24. preference, convenient, releif	
25. awkward, considerably, neccessasry	

Section-B: Poetry

INTRODUCTION: ELEMENTS OF POETRY

What will I learn?

- Comprehend the use of literary features/techniques of poetry.
- Analyse to use in their writing the features of an expository composition showing comparison and contrast between things, events, situations, places, action, idea or a problem: use of effective metaphors and similes.
- Utilize appropriate informational print and electronic sources to collect information.

Pre-reading

1. Recite any of your favourite poems in Sindhi, Urdu or English.

What is poetry?

Poetry is a verbal or written expression of feelings and ideas in an imaginative style with distinctive rhythm, rhyme, and meter. These all work together with the sounds, meanings, and associations of the words themselves to produce one significant effect. Understanding or appreciating poetry requires some acquaintance with the basic elements of poetry.

ELEMENTS OF POETRY

Terms	Description
Line	Poetry contains lines. The length of a line may be measured in two ways: the number of syllables in it or the number of stresses. Example: Thus in the winter stands the lonely tree. (This verse has ten syllables or five meters.)
Foot	The foot is a formative measuring unit in poetry that is made up of stressed and unstressed syllables. The combination of feet creates meter in poetry. Later, these meters join for the composition of a complete poem.
Meter	Meter functions as a means of imposing a specific number of syllables in a line of poetry. It consists of the number of syllables and the pattern of emphasis on those syllables. The most widely used meter in English poetry is iambic pentameter that is a line or verse with five metrical feet, each consisting of one short (or unstressed) syllable followed by one long (or stressed) syllable. Example: Close bosom-friend of the maturing sun; -- Keats
Stanza	Stanza is the division of a poem in a certain number of lines having the same meter, rhyme, and a unifying idea or image. Stanza is identified with a number of lines it contains. Thus, a couplet has two lines, a tercet has three lines, a quatrain has four lines, a quintain has five, a sestet has six lines, a septet has seven, and an octave has eight lines. Example: How happy is he born or taught, That serveth not another's will; Whose armour is his honest thought, And simple truth his highest skill.
Rhyme	It is the same sound at the end of poetic lines.

Rhyming pattern	A convenient way of setting out a pattern of rhymes is to write for (a) the first rhyme, (b) for the second, (c) for the third, and so on. Example: The people along the sand. (a) All turn and look one way. (b) They turn their back on the land. (a) They look at the sea all day. (b)
Free verse	Free verse is a poem that doesn't rhyme and doesn't have a regular rhythm or meter.

Forms and Genres of Poetry

Poetry can be broadly divided into three types: lyrical, narrative, and descriptive. Further, poetry can be classified into forms and genres based on structure, content, and style. Here are some important forms and genres of poetry.

Forms/ Genres	Description
Lyric	A lyric poem is a short but highly musical verse that conveys powerful feelings. It has rhyme, meter, or other literary devices.
Sonnet	The word 'sonnet' means little song. A sonnet is a 14-line lyrical poem divided into two stanzas: an octave and a sestet. The sonnet's three main types are the Italian, the English and the Spenserian.
Elegy	Elegy is a lyrical poem expressing sorrow over the death of a loved one.
Ode	Ode is also a kind of lyrical poem usually written in the form of an address commonly glorifying an event or individual.
Ballad	A ballad is a narrative poem that tells a story, usually in four-line stanzas called quatrains.
Epic	Epic is a long narrative poem that tells the heroic exploits of a legendary hero.

Poetic Devices and Figures of Speech

Poets use poetic devices and figures of speech in order to enhance the meaning or mood of a poem. Here are some essential poetic devices and figures of speech.

Poetic Devices/ Figures of Speech	Description
Simile	A simile is a direct comparison between two unlike things, usually with the words like or as. Example: The muscles on his brawny arms are strong as iron bands.
Metaphor	Metaphor is an implied comparison between two relatively unlike things without like or as. Example: The road was a ribbon of moonlight.
Personification	Personification gives the qualities of a human to an animal, an object, or an idea. Example: a brave handsome tree fell with a creaking rending cry
Hyperbole	It is an exaggerated statement used to heighten the effect. Example: She's said so on several million occasions
Alliteration	Alliteration is the repeated consonant sounds at the beginning of words. Example: Wide-eyed and wondering while we wait for others to waken.
Onomatopoeia	It is the use of words that mimic sounds. Example: Crackle!

Oxymoron	It is the contradictory words used together signifying two different but exact ideas. Examples: He is the wisest fool of them all.
Irony	It is a situation that means quite opposite to what is apparently said. Example: A post on Facebook complaining how useless Facebook is.
Symbol	A symbol is an object that represents something else rather than itself. Example: Ah Sun-flower, weary of time, Who countest the steps of the sun; -- William Blake
Imagery	Imagery is the use of words to create an image or images in the reader's mind based on five senses. Examples: I wandered lonely as a cloud That floats on high o'er vales and hills. --- Wordsworth

Exercise 1

Answer the following questions. Write down your answers in your notebook, and share it with your class fellows once you have completed.

1. What is meant by rhyme in poetry?
2. What is meter in poetry?
3. What are different kinds of stanza?
4. What is a sonnet?
5. What is function of the poetic devices?

Exercise 2

Work in pairs. See the picture below and read the poem of William Wordsworth very carefully and answer the questions. Each pair should write down their answers in their notebooks. After you have completed this exercise, exchange your work with other pairs.



Earth has not anything to show more fair:
Dull would he be of soul who could pass by
A sight so touching in its majesty:
This City now doth, like a garment, wear
The beauty of the morning; silent, bare,
Ships, towers, domes, theatres, and temples lie
Open unto the fields, and to the sky;
All bright and glittering in the smokeless air.

Never did sun more beautifully steep
In his first splendour, valley, rock, or hill;
Ne'er saw I, never felt, a calm so deep!
The river glideth at his own sweet will:
Dear God! the very houses seem asleep;
And all that mighty heart is lying still!

1. What type of poem is it? Explain and justify your answer.
2. How many stanzas are there and what are they called?
3. Write down the rhyming scheme of the poem?

Exercise 3

Work individually. Read the elements of poetry and find out which of the following statements are correct and incorrect. For correct statements, put a tick (✓); and for incorrect ones, put a cross (X). After completing, compare your answers with your partner.

No	Statement	Correct/ Incorrect
1	Two lines which rhyme at the end are called a couplet.	
2	There is no convenient way of setting out a pattern of rhymes.	
3	Imagery is the use of figurative language to represent objects, actions, and ideas.	
4	Usually a sonnet is comprised of 14 lines having certain rhyming scheme.	
5	Ballad is expressed for sorrow, grief or death.	
6	A metaphor states explicitly that one thing is like another.	

Exercise 4

Work in pairs. Read the following examples of various figures of speech and write the name of corresponding figures of speech against each. Once you have completed, share it with your partner.

No	Example	Figure of Speech
1	To enter in the thoughts of desperate men.	
2	They speak like saints and act like devils.	
3	How could he be a king, a soldier and a peon?	
4	How high, his highness holds his haughty head.	
5	What avail me, all my Kingdoms?	
6	Hasten slowly.	
7	Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more.	
8	Life is a dream.	
9	She was as proud as a peacock.	
10	More haste, less speed.	

Exercise 5

Work individually. Read the following sentences and convert them as directed in the brackets against each. You can add new words in these sentences while converting these. Share your work with your class fellows once you have completed.

- 1) He is as sober as a judge. (metaphor)
- 2) She was a tower of strength in their trouble. (simile)
- 3) Necessity knows no law. (oxymoron)
- 4) He is the wisest fool of them all. (personification)
- 5) The professor's ideas are as old as the hills. (irony)
- 6) The fire station burned down last night. (hyperbole)

Exercise 6

Most of the figures of speech are very common in our daily use. Work in pairs and collect as many other common examples of above-mentioned figures of speech in Exercise 4. Once you have done, display them in front of the class by writing on the charts.

What will I learn?

- Use pre-reading strategies to predict content of a text.
- Use while-reading strategies to apply critical thinking, while exploring and interacting with the text.
- Use post-reading strategies to critically evaluate the text and to give a personal opinion.
- Comprehend the use of literary features/techniques of poetry.
- Analyse the context and contents of a poem.
- Express spontaneous personal response to the poem.
- Identify facts/opinions in the given literary text.
- Express personal responses to the given literary text through creativity and imagination.
- State the lessons/understanding learned from the given text.
- Identify the character/poem/situation that inspired you and state the reason.

Pre-reading

1. What is happiness according to you?
2. Write briefly in the boxes the things/ideas that make you happy.

**The Character of a Happy Life**

Sir Henry Wotton

How happy is he born or taught
That serveth not another's will;
Whose armour is his honest thought
And simple truth his utmost skill!

4

Whose passions not his masters are,
Whose soul is still prepared for death,
Untied unto the world by care
Of public fame, or private breath:

8

Who envies none that chance doth raise,
Nor vice: who never understood
How deepest wounds are given by praise;
Nor rules of state, but rules of good;

12

Note for teachers: Elicit response to pre-reading questions and accept all the responses. Make sure that all students participate. Next, ask the students to listen and follow the lines as you read the poem aloud. After that, divide the students in groups and randomly call upon one by one in group to recite the poem aloud with intonation and appropriate gestures.

Who hath his life from rumours freed;
Whose conscience is his strong retreat;
Whose state can neither flatterers feed,
Nor ruin make oppressors great; 16

Who God doth late and early pray
More of His grace than gifts to lend;
And entertains the harmless day
With a religious book or friend; 20

This man is freed from servile bands
Of hope to rise, or fear to fall:
Lord of himself, though not of lands,
And having nothing, yet hath all. 24

Exercise 1

Column A has words from the poem; underline these words in the poem. Column B has the contextual meanings of these words, but they are jumbled up. Work in pairs. Try and match the appropriate meaning of each word, and write your answer in column C. Share your work with your partner after you have completed.

No	Column A		Column B	Column C
1	passion	A	unverified or doubtful information	
2	armour	B	move back	
3	rumours	C	jealous	
4	conscience	D	a metallic covering to protect from attack	
5	retreat	E	moral sense of right and wrong	
6	servile bands	F	destruction	
7	envy	G	slavish bonds	
8	ruin	H	strong emotions	

Exercise 2

Work in pairs and read the above poem again. Comprehend it thoroughly and paraphrase it in simple words. After you have completed, share it with your partner. The Stanza-1 is paraphrased for you as an example.

In the first stanza of the poem 'The Character of a Happy Life', Sir Henry Wotton says that a happy man does not rely on others. He does not work according to others' will. He is neither a slave nor needs any weapon to protect himself. His honesty is his only weapon. He believes in simple truth of life. This simple truth is his reliable skill.

Exercise 3

Read the poem again and encircle the right option.

1. The strong retreat for a happy man is his _____.
a. heart b. thoughts
c. mind d. conscience
2. According to the poet, a happy man cares much about _____.
a. worldly needs b. material uplift
c. character d. finance
3. A happy man's armour is his _____ thought.
a. clever b. honest
c. deep d. lofty
4. A happy man's days are _____.
a. joyful b. carefree
c. harmless d. playful
5. _____ is the utmost skill of an honest man.
a. truth b. honesty
c. simplicity d. wisdom
6. A happy man does not serve another's _____.
a. order b. direction
c. wish d. will
7. A happy man's soul is always prepared for _____.
a. exam b. fight
c. quarrel d. death
8. According to the poet, the deepest wounds are always given by _____.
a. back-biting b. praise
c. trust d. friendship

Exercise 4

Work in pairs and pick out the line(s) from 'The Character of a Happy Life' in which the poet has identified each of the following characteristics of a happy man. Write their corresponding character against each quality in the table given below. Once you have completed, compare your work with your partner.

No	Characteristics	Qualities
1		Independence
2		Honesty
3		Truthfulness
4		Ambition
5		Self-control
6		Envy
7		No greed
8		Piety

Exercise 5

Read the poem again and answer the following questions.

1. What does the poet mean when he says that a happy man does not serve another's will?
2. Explain briefly, how Sir Henry Wotton's happy man is 'having nothing yet hath all'.
3. What a happy man is taught from his very birth?
4. Write the central idea of the poem 'The Character of a Happy Life'.
5. Write the rhyming scheme of the poem.
6. What are the sources of happiness other than those mentioned in the poem?

Exercise 6

Work individually and identify the poetic devices in the poem. Make a list of them and use them in your sentences. Share your work with your class fellows after you have completed.

Exercise 7

Work in pairs and give a critical appreciation of the poem based on the following aspects. After you have written, compare your work with your partner.

1. Poetic Diction 2. Theme 3. Structure
3. Language 5. Message

Exercise 8

Work in groups of three. Compose your own poem on the theme of happiness using elements of poetry based on three stanzas. Each member of the group should compose 1 stanza. After your group has composed the poem, exchange it with other groups.

Exercise 9

Work individually and explain the following stanzas. Write down your work in the notebook and share it with your class fellows after you have completed.

Stanzas	Lines
1	How happy.....utmost skill!
2	Whose passions or private breath:
3	Who envies nonebut rules of good;
4	Who hath his lifemake oppressors great;
5	Who God doth late..... book or friend;
6	This man is freed..... yet hath all.

What will I learn?

- Use pre-reading strategies to predict content of a text.
- Use while-reading strategies to apply critical thinking, while exploring and interacting with the text.
- Use post-reading strategies to critically evaluate the text and to give a personal opinion.
- Identify the character/poem/situation that inspired you and state the reason.
- Make connections between one's own life and the characters, events, motives and causes displayed in literature.
- Recognize recurring themes and the existence of universal human emotions across literary works.
- Express students' personal response to the overall effect of the given literary text.
- Interpret the literary themes with real life situations, social and cultural norms.

Pre-reading

1. Read about the following famous personalities who turned their failures into success.
2. What comes to your mind after reading them?

Famous Failures

	Abraham Lincoln failed in business three times and failed campaigning seven times prior to becoming the President of the United States.
	Albert Einstein was expelled from school and his teachers described him as "mentally slow" but he became a great scientist.
	J.K. Rowling's novel "Harry Potter" was rejected by 12 publishing houses before it became the world's number one best-selling book.

Don't Quit

By Edgar A. Guest

When things go wrong, as they sometimes will,
 When the road you're trudging seems all uphill,
 When the funds are low and debts are high,
 And you want to smile but have to sigh,
 When care is pressing you down a bit,
 Rest, if you must, but don't you quit. 6

Life is queer with its twists and turns,
 As every one of us sometimes learns,
 And many a failure turns about,
 When he might have won had he stuck it out;
 Don't give up though the pace seems slow-
 You might succeed with another blow. 12

Note for teachers: Elicit response to pre-reading questions and accept all the responses. Make sure that all students participate. Next, ask the students to listen and follow the lines as you read the poem aloud. After that, divide the students in groups and randomly call upon them one by one in group to recite the poem aloud with intonation and appropriate gestures.

Often the goal is nearer than,
 It seems to a faint and faltering man,
 Often the struggler has given up,
 When he might have captured the victor's cup.
 And he learned too late when the night slipped down,
 How close he was to the golden crown. 18

Success is failure turned inside out-
 The silver tint of clouds of doubt,
 And you never can tell how close you are,
 It may be near when it seems so far,
 So stick to the fight when you're hardest hit-
 It's when things seem worst that you mustn't quit. 24

Exercise 1

Column A has words from the poem; underline these words in the poem. Column B has the contextual meanings of these words, but they are jumbled up. Work in pairs. Try and match the appropriate meaning of each word, and write your answer in column C. Share your work with your partner after you have completed.

No	Column A		Column B	Column C
1	trudge	a	strange	
2	quit	b	speed	
3	queer	c	a long deep breath	
4	pace	d	to walk slowly	
5	twist	e	to stop	
6	stuck	f	caught	
7	tint	g	an unexpected change	
8	sigh	h	shade	

Exercise 4

Read the poem again and answer the following questions.

1. What is the poet's message in the first stanza?
2. Which lines of the poem do you like the most and why?
3. Write the central idea of the poem.
4. Find similes, metaphors and alliterations in the poem.
5. Discuss how the poem helps the reader to be optimistic in every situation.
6. What effect does the poem create on the reader?
7. What is the message of the poem?
8. Why does the poet term life 'queer with twists and turns'?
9. What is the benefit of not quitting as suggested in the poem?

Exercise 5

Work individually and identify the poetic devices in the poem. Make a list of them and use them in your sentences. Share your work with your class fellows after you have completed.

Exercise 6

Work in pairs and give a critical appreciation of the poem based on the following aspects. Compare your work with your partner.

1. Poetic Diction
2. Theme
3. Structure
4. Language
5. Message

Exercise 7

Work individually and explain the following stanzas. Write down your work in the notebook and share it with your class fellows.

Stanzas	Lines
1	When things go wrong but don't you quit.
2	Life is queer with another blow.
3	Often the goal to the golden crown.
4	Success is failurethat you mustn't quit.

Exercise 8

Work in groups of three. Compose your own poem on the theme of 'Don't Give Up', using elements of poetry based on three stanzas. Each member of the group should compose 1 stanza. After your group has composed the poem, exchange it with other groups.

What will I learn?

- Use pre-reading strategies to predict content of a text.
- Use while-reading strategies to apply critical thinking, while exploring and interacting with the text.
- Use post-reading strategies to critically evaluate the text and to give a personal opinion.
- Analyse the context and content of a poem.
- Recognize recurring themes and the existence of universal human emotions across literary works.
- Analyse how writer has used language and style.
- State the lessons/understanding learned from the given text.



Ozymandias was a Greek name for the Egyptian pharaoh Ramesses II, famous for the number of architectural structures which he got constructed. Shelly wrote the poem Ozymandias which describes a broken statue of Ramesses II, lying forgotten in the desert.

Pre-reading

1. Read the following quote and guess the theme of the poem:
“Graveyards are full of the people who thought themselves indispensable”

Ozymandias

Percy Bysshe Shelley

I met a traveller from an antique land,
Who said— “Two vast and trunkless legs of stone
Stand in the desert. Near them, on the sand
Half sunk, a shattered visage lies, whose frown,
And wrinkled lip, and sneer of cold command
Tell that its sculptor well those passions read,
Which yet survive, stamped on these lifeless things
The hand that mocked them, and the heart that fed; 8

And on the pedestal, these words appear:
My name is Ozymandias, King of Kings;
Look on my Works, ye Mighty, and despair!
Nothing beside remains. Round the decay
Of that Colossal Wreck, boundless and bare,
The lone and level sands stretch far away.”- 14

Note for teachers: Elicit response to pre-reading questions and accept all the responses. Make sure that all students participate. Next, ask the students to listen and follow the lines as you read the poem aloud. After that, divide the students in groups and randomly call upon each of the member of group to recite the poem aloud with intonation and appropriate gestures.

Exercise 1

Column A has words from the poem; underline these words in the poem. Column B has the contextual meanings of these words, but they are jumbled up. Work in pairs. Try and match the appropriate meaning of each word, and write your answer in column C. Share your work with your partner after you have completed.

No	Column A		Column B	Column C
1	frown	a	the parts left over	
2	visage	b	an artist who makes sculpture	
3	sculptor	c	huge	
4	mock	d	a displeasing or concentrating face	
5	pedestal	e	make fun of	
6	colossal	f	the base of sculpture	
7	remains	g	a human or animal face	

Exercise 2

Read the poem again and encircle the correct option.

- 'Ozymandias' is a poem depicting that the life is _____.
a. beautiful b. transient c. attractive d. alluring
- The poet met a traveller from _____.
a. an ancient land b. aboard
c. a neighbouring country d. a desert
- The traveller told the poet that he had seen _____ in the desert.
a. a statue b. a sculptor c. an oasis d. a snake
- The words on the base of statue tell us that the king Ozymandias was a _____ king.
a. kind b. humble c. proud d. cruel
- The message of the poem for all powerful authority and glory is _____.
a. 'sands stretch far away' b. 'frown and wrinkled lips'
c. 'nothing remains' d. 'stamped on these lifeless things'
- In the poem 'Ozymandias', the condition of the statue is _____.
a. good b. bad c. excellent d. marvellous
- 'My name is Ozymandias – King of Kings;' is _____ literary device.
a. Simile b. Irony c. Personification d. Metaphor
- One of the following lines does NOT make use of alliteration in the poem.
a. The lone and level sands stretch far away
b. I met a traveller from an antique land
c. Nothing beside remains. Round the decay
d. Half sunk, a shattered visage lies, whose frown

Exercise 3

Work in pairs and read the above poem again. Comprehend it thoroughly and paraphrase it in simple words. After you have completed, share your work with your partner.

Exercise 4

Read the poem again and answer the following questions.

1. What did the traveller see in the desert and whom he told about it?
2. How can you say that the sculptor was a great artist?
3. What was written on the pedestal of the statue of Ozymandias?
4. What is the meaning of the phrase in the poem "the heart that fed"?
5. What is ironic about the fate of Ozymandias?
6. What is the message of the poem?
7. How does this poem relate to your life?
8. The proud Ozymandias lies forgotten in the desert. Comment.

Exercise 5

Work in pairs and give a critical appreciation of the poem based on the following aspects. Compare your work with your partner after you have done it.

1. Poetic Diction
2. Theme
3. Structure
4. Language
5. Message

Exercise 6

'Every rise has a fall.' Work in pairs and discuss it in the light of the poem.

Exercise 7

Work individually and explain the following lines. Write down your work in the notebook and share it with your class fellows.

Line No.	Lines
1-8	I met a traveller and the heart that fed;
9-14	And on the pedestal stretch far away.

Exercise 8

Work in groups of three. Compose your own poem on the theme of 'all power is temporary, no matter how proud a person is'. Make sure that you are using the elements of poetry. Each member of group should compose 1 stanza. After your group has composed the poem, exchange it with other groups.

What will I learn?

- Use pre-reading strategies to predict content of a text.
- Use while-reading strategies to apply critical thinking, while exploring and interacting with the text.
- Use post-reading strategies to critically evaluate the text and to give a personal opinion.
- Listen to and read a given poem with intonation to comprehend the use of sound in poetry; rhyme and rhythm; rise and fall, syllable stress/unstress.
- Make connections between one's own life and the characters, events, motives and causes displayed in literature.
- Recognize recurring themes and the existence of universal human emotions across literary works.
- Analyse the context and contents of a poem.
- Express personal responses to the given literary text through creativity and imagination.
- State the lessons/understanding learned from the given text.



Pre-reading

1. "The stronger the wind, the stronger the tree".
Read the line and guess the theme of the poem.

Good Timber

By Douglas Malloch

The tree that never had to fight
For sun and sky and air and light,
But stood out in the open plain
And always got its share of rain,
Never became a forest king
But lived and died a scrubby thing. 6

The man who never had to toil
To gain and farm his patch of soil,
Who never had to win his share
Of sun and sky and light and air,
Never became a manly man
But lived and died as he began. 12

Good timber does not grow with ease,
The stronger wind, the stronger trees,
The further sky, the greater length
The more the storm, the more the strength,
By sun and cold, by rain and snow
In trees and men good timbers grow. 18

Where thickest lies the forest growth
We find the patriarchs of both,
And they hold counsel with the stars
Whose broken branches show the scars,
Of many winds and much of strife
This is the common law of life. 24

Note for teachers: Elicit response to pre-reading question and accept all the responses. Make sure that all students participate. Next, ask the students to listen and follow the lines as you read the poem aloud. After that, divide the students in groups and randomly call upon each member of group to recite the poem aloud with intonation and appropriate gestures.

Exercise 1

Work in pairs and find out the meaning of the following words by using dictionary. Read the poem carefully and write the contextual meaning against each word. After completing, share your work with your partner.

No	Word	Contextual meaning
1	timber	
2	scrubby	
3	toil	
4	patriarchs	
5	counsel	
6	scars	

Exercise 2

Read the poem again and encircle the right option.

- The poem explains to us that good qualities always develop in _____.
a. hardships
b. ease
c. idleness
d. illness
- "Never became a forest king" means never _____.
a. became a lion
b. acquired a prominent position
c. possessed courage to fight
d. enjoyed life
- "But lived and died as he began" points out towards _____ human being.
a. a courageous
b. an effortless
c. a wealthy
d. a successful
- In the poem 'Good Timber', the poet discusses themes of _____.
a. nature, wealth and defeat
b. power, relationship and hope
c. nature, struggle and fulfilment
d. nature, nurture and chaos
- The poem teaches us that the people reach their true potential by overcoming _____.
a. feelings
b. enemies
c. desires
d. adversities
- "But lived and died a scrubby thing" means lived a/an _____.
a. unimportant
b. high status
c. useful
d. comfortable
- 'By sun and cold, by rain and snow' is _____ literary device.
a. Metaphor
b. Oxymoron
c. Alliteration
d. Simile
- "Broken branches" in last stanza is the example of _____.
a. simile
b. metaphor
c. hyperbole
d. none of them

Exercise 3

Read the poem again and answer the following questions.

1. What is the significance of the title of the poem?
2. What happens to the people who work hard?
3. How can one achieve one's true potential in life according to the poem?
4. Why does the poet suggest people to be like good timber?
5. Which poetic devices are used in the poem?
6. Write central idea of the poem.
7. How does this poem relate to your life?

Exercise 4

Work individually and identify the poetic devices in the poem. Make a list of them and use them in your sentences. Share your work with your class fellows once you have completed.

Exercise 5

Work in pairs and give a critical appreciation of the poem based on the following aspects. Once you have written, compare your work with your partner.

1. Poetic Diction
2. Theme
3. Structure
4. Language
5. Message

Exercise 6

Work in groups of three. Compose your own poem on the theme of 'When life gives you lemons, make lemonade', using elements of poetry based on three stanzas. Each member of group should compose 1 stanza. Once your group has composed the poem, exchange it with other groups.

Exercise 7

'Life grows when a person comes out of comfort zone.' Elaborate this statement in the light of the poem 'The Good Timber'. Note down your points in the notebook and share it with your class fellows.

Exercise 8

Work individually and explain the following lines. Write down your work in the notebook and share it with your class fellows once you have completed.

Line No.	Lines
1-6	The tree thata scrubby thing.
7-12	The man whodied as he began.
13-18	Good timber does not..... good timbers grow.
19-24	Where thickest lies.....common law of life.

What will I learn?

- Use pre-reading strategies to predict content of a text.
- Use while-reading strategies to apply critical thinking, while exploring and interacting with the text.
- Use post-reading strategies to critically evaluate the text and to give a personal opinion.
- Analyse the context and contents of a poem.
- Express personal responses to the given literary text through creativity and imagination.
- Identify the problem in given text and provide solution.



Pre-reading

1. Look at the picture and express what you observe in it.
2. How can you describe an obedient child?
3. How much are your parents attached to you?
4. Does anyone among you know any story related to a child?
5. What do you know about William Wordsworth?

Lucy Gray

William Wordsworth

Oft I had heard of Lucy Gray:
And, when I crossed the wild,
I chanced to see at break of day
The solitary child. 4

No mate, no comrade Lucy knew;
She dwelt on a wide moor,
--The sweetest thing that ever grew
Beside a human door! 8

You yet may spy the fawn at play,
The hare upon the green;
But the sweet face of Lucy Gray
Will never more be seen. 12

"To-night will be a stormy night--
You to the town must go;
And take a lantern, Child, to light
Your mother through the snow." 16

Note for teachers: Elicit response to pre-reading questions and accept all the responses. Make sure that all students participate. Next, ask the students to listen and follow the lines as you read the poem aloud. After that, divide the students in groups and randomly call upon each member of the group to recite the poem aloud with intonation and appropriate gestures.

"That, Father! will I gladly do:
'Tis scarcely afternoon--
The minster-clock has just struck two,
And yonder is the moon!" 20

At this the Father raised his hook,
And snapped a faggot-band;
He plied his work;--and Lucy took
The lantern in her hand. 24

Not blither is the mountain roe:
With many a wanton stroke
Her feet disperse the powdery snow,
That rises up like smoke. 28

The storm came on before its time:
She wandered up and down;
And many a hill did Lucy climb:
But never reached the town. 32

The wretched parents all that night
Went shouting far and wide;
But there was neither sound nor sight
To serve them for a guide. 36

At day-break on a hill they stood
That overlooked the moor;
And thence they saw the bridge of wood,
A furlong from their door. 40

They wept--and, turning homeward, cried,
"In heaven we all shall meet;"
--When in the snow the mother spied
The print of Lucy's feet. 44

Then downwards from the steep hill's edge
 They tracked the footmarks small;
 And through the broken hawthorn hedge,
 And by the long stone-wall; 48

And then an open field they crossed:
 The marks were still the same;
 They tracked them on, nor ever lost;
 And to the bridge they came. 52

They followed from the snowy bank
 Those footmarks, one by one,
 Into the middle of the plank;
 And further there were none! 56

--Yet some maintain that to this day
 She is a living child;
 That you may see sweet Lucy Gray
 Upon the lonesome wild. 60

O'er rough and smooth she trips along,
 And never looks behind;
 And sings a solitary song
 That whistles in the wind. 64

Exercise 1

Work in pairs and find out the meaning of the following words by using dictionary. Read the poem carefully and write the contextual meaning against each word. After completing, share your work with your partner.

No.	Words	Contextual Meaning
1	solitary	
2	wretched	
3	comrade	
4	wanton	
5	tripping	

Exercise 2

Read the poem again and encircle the correct option.

1. The poet chanced to see Lucy _____.
a. at the break of day b. in the evening
c. in the afternoon d. at night
2. Lucy's father asked Lucy to go to the town with a lantern to bring her _____.
a. aunt b. sister
c. brother d. mother
3. Lucy replied to her father that she would _____ go to the town to take back her mother.
a. gladly b. sadly
c. unwillingly d. probably
4. Lucy couldn't reach the town because _____.
a. it was late b. she didn't get any conveyance
c. her mother reached home d. she lost her way in storm
5. The wooden bridge was at distance of _____ from Lucy's home.
a. a mile b. a furlong c. a kilometre d. a few feet
6. Lucy's parents became certain of her death when they saw _____.
a. her foot prints b. her body
c. her lantern d. her shoes
7. Some people still believe that Lucy can be seen _____.
a. in mountains b. in wind c. in town d. on bridge
8. People believe Lucy can be seen doing these activities except _____.
a. looking straight b. singing songs
c. moving rapidly d. talking to people

Exercise 3

Read the poem again and answer the following questions.

1. Where did Lucy live and what kind of child she was?
2. Where did Lucy's father send her and why?
3. What did Lucy mean when she said 'yonder is the moon'?
4. Why did Lucy take lantern with her?
5. Do you think that the tragedy would have been prevented if Lucy's father himself had gone down the town?
6. What happened to Lucy while she was going to the town?
7. What efforts did Lucy's parents make in finding her?
8. What led the Lucy's parents to the bridge?
9. What do people still maintain about Lucy Gray and why?

Exercise 4

Work in pairs and give a critical appreciation of the poem based on the following aspects. Once you have written, compare your work with your partner.

- | | | |
|-------------------|------------|--------------|
| 1. Poetic Diction | 2. Theme | 3. Structure |
| 4. Language | 5. Message | |

Exercise 5

How should elders guide their children to save themselves from some forcible dangers? Work in pairs and discuss about it.

Exercise 6

Work individually and explain with reference to the context the following stanzas. Write down your work in the notebook and share it with your class fellows after you have completed.

Line No.	Lines
1	Oft I had heardthe solitary child.
2	No mate, no comrade Lucy..... Beside a human door!
3	You yet may spy..... will never more be seen.
4	"To-night will bethrough the snow."
5	"That, father, will I gladly..... yonder is the moon."
6	At this the father..... lantern in her hand.
7	Not blither is the mountain..... rises up like smoke.
8	The storm came on.....reached the town.
9	The wretched parents.....serve them for a guide.
10	At daybreak on.....furlong from their door.
11	They wept-and, turning.....of Lucy's feet.
12	Then downwards long stone-wall:
13	And then an openthey came.

Exercise 7

Work in groups of three. Compose your own poem on the theme of 'self-awareness' using elements of poetry based on three stanzas. Each member of group should compose 1 stanza. Once your group has composed the poem, exchange it with other groups.

What will I learn?

- Use pre-reading strategies to predict content of a text.
- Use while-reading strategies to apply critical thinking, while exploring and interacting with the text.
- Use post-reading strategies to critically evaluate the text and to give a personal opinion.
- Role-play to perform different characters given in literary text.
- Know that the purpose of literature is to entertain, inform and persuade the reader/audience in diverse ways.
- Understand to make connections between one's own life and the characters, events, motives and causes displayed in literature.
- Comprehend the use of literary features/techniques of poetry (rhyme, rhythm, alliteration).
- Analyse the context and contents of a poem.

Pre-reading

"That a fool he may learn a wise man wit."

Predict the theme of the poem after reading the line.

The Abbot of Canterbury

An ancient story I'll tell you anon
Of a notable prince that was called King John;
And he ruled England with main and with might,
For he did great wrong and maintained little right. 4

And I'll tell you a story, a story so merry,
Concerning the Abbot of Canterbury;
How for his housekeeping, and high renown
They rode post for him to fair London town. 8

An hundred men, the king did hear say,
The abbot kept in his house every day;
And fifty gold chains, without any doubt,
In velvet coats waited the abbot about. 12

'How now, father abbot? I hear it of thee,
Thou keepest a far better house than me;
And for thy housekeeping and high renown,
I fear thou work'st treason against my crown.' 16

'My liege', quoth the abbot, 'I would it were known
I never spend nothing but what is my own;
And I trust your grace will do me no dere
For spending of my own true-gotten gear.' 20

Note for teachers: Elicit response to pre-reading question and accept all the responses. Make sure that all students participate. Next, ask the students to listen and follow the lines as you read the poem aloud. After that, divide the students in groups and randomly call upon each member of group to recite the poem aloud with intonation and appropriate gestures.

'Yes, yes, father abbot, thy fault it is high,
And now for the same thou needest must die;
For except thou canst answer my questions three;
Thy head shall be smitten from thy body. 24

'And first,' quoth the king 'when I'm in this stead,
With my crown of gold so fair on my head,
Among all my liege-men so noble of birth,
Thou must tell me to one penny what I am worth. 28

'Secondly, tell me, without any doubt
How soon I may ride the whole world about,
And at the third question thou must not shrink,
But tell me here truly what I do think.' 32

'O, these are hard questions for my shallow wit.
Nor I cannot answer your grace as yet;
But if you will give me but three weeks' space,
I'll do my endeavour to answer your grace.' 36

'Now three weeks' space to thee will I give,
And that is the longest time thou hast to live;
For if thou dost not answer my questions three,
Thy lands and thy living are forfeit to me. 40

Away rode the abbot all sad at that word,
And he rode to Cambridge and Oxenford;
But never a doctor there was so wise,
That could with his learning an answer devise. 44

Then home rode the abbot of comfort so cold,
And he met his shepherd a-going to folds;
How now my lord abbot, you are welcome home;
What news do you bring us from good King John? 48

'Sad news, sad news, shepherd, I must give;
That I have but three days more to live;
For if I do not answer him questions three,
My head will be smitten from my body.' 52

'The first is to tell him there in that stead,
With his crown of gold so fair on his head,
Among all his liege-men so noble of birth,
To within one penny of what he is worth.' 56
'The second, to tell him, without any doubt,
How soon he may ride this whole world about;
And at the third question I must not shrink,
To tell him there truly what he does think.' 60

'Now cheer up, sir abbot! Did you never hear yet,
That a fool he may learn a wise man wit?
Lend me horse, and serving-men and your apparel,
And I'll ride to London to answer your quarrel.' 64

'Nay, frown not, if it hath been told upto me,
I am like your lordship as ever may be;
And if you will but lend me your gown,
There is none shall know us at fair London town.' 68

'Now horses and serving-men thou shalt have,
With sumptuous array most gallant and brave,
With crozier and mitre, and rochet, and cope,
Fit to appear, 'fore our father the Pope.' 72

'Now welcome, sir abbot" the king did say,
'Tis well thou'rt come back to keep thy day;
For and if thou canst answer my questions three,
Thy life and thy living both saved shall be.' 76

'And first, when thou seest me here in this stead,
With my crown of gold so fair on my head,
Among all my liege-men so noble of birth,
Tell me to one penny what I am worth.' 80

'For thirty pence our Saviour was sold
Among the false Jews, as I have been told;
And twenty-nine is the worth of thee,
For I think thou'rt one penny worse than He.' 84

The king he laughed, and swore by Saint Bittel;
'I did not think I had been worth so little!
Now secondly tell me without any doubt,
How soon I may ride this whole world about.' 88

'You must rise with the sun and ride with the same,
Until the next morning he riseth again,
And then your face need not make any doubt,
But in twenty-four hours you ride it about.' 92

The king he laughed, and swore by Saint John;
'I did not think it could be done so soon!
Now from the third question thou must not shrink,
But tell me here truly what I do think.' 96

'Yes, that shall I do, and make your grace merry;
You think I'm the abbot of Canterbury;
But I'm his poor shepherd, as plain you may see.
That am come to beg pardon for him and for me.' 100

The king he laughed, and swore by the mass,
'I'll make thee lord abbot this day in his place!
"Now nay, my liege, be not in such speed,
For alack! I can neither write nor read." 104

'Four nobles a week, then, I will give thee,
For this merry jest thou hast show unto me;
And tell the old abbot, when thou comest home,
Thou hast brought him a pardon from good King John.' 108

Exercise 1

Column A has words from the poem; underline these words in the poem. Column B has the contextual meanings of these words, but they are jumbled up. Work in pairs. Try and match the appropriate meaning of each word, and write your answer in column C. Share your work with your partner once you have completed.

No	Column A		Column B	Column C
1	ancient	A	soon	
2	merry	B	noblemen	
3	anon	C	plan	
4	renown	D	forgiveness	
5	fold	E	joke	
6	gallant	F	primitive	
7	jest	G	brave	
8	pardon	H	happy	
9	liegemen	I	enclosure	
10	devise	J	fame	

Exercise 2

Read the poem again and encircle the right option.

- The ballad 'The Abbot of Canterbury' is narrated in _____ person.
 - first
 - second
 - third
 - first and third
- The poet says to the reader that he is going to tell a _____ story.
 - sad
 - funny
 - terrible
 - folk
- King John was jealous of Abbot's housekeeping and high _____.
 - character
 - respect
 - business
 - renown

4. King John feared that the Abbot was working against his _____.
 - a. people
 - b. policies
 - c. crown
 - d. ministers
5. King John told the Abbot if he did not answer his three questions he would be _____.
 - a. beheaded
 - b. poisoned
 - c. banished
 - d. fined
6. After listening to the King's questions, the Abbot rode to _____ universities.
 - a. Oxford and California
 - b. Oxford and Canterbury
 - c. Oxford and Campbell
 - d. Oxford and Cambridge
7. The Abbot requested the King to give him _____ weeks space.
 - a. three
 - b. four
 - c. five
 - d. six
8. While going back to his home town, the Abbot met a _____.
 - a. farmer
 - b. friend
 - c. neighbour
 - d. shepherd
9. The shepherd demanded Abbot's _____ to answer King's questions
 - a. lands
 - b. house
 - c. horse and dress
 - d. wealth

Exercise 3

Work in pairs and read the lines given below carefully. Write down the number of the stanza against each statement in which the given information appears.

No	Statement	Stanza
1	Abbot is a very rich person.	
2	Abbot seems satisfied in the court.	
3	Questions are very difficult to answer.	
4	Abbot tries to find out the answers.	
5	Abbot is sure to have his punishment.	
6	The king rewards the shepherd.	

Exercise 4

Read the poem again and answer the following questions.

1. What was the dispute between the King and the Abbot?
2. What efforts did the Abbot make in order to save himself?
3. What were the questions that the King asked?
4. What was the shepherd's answer to the first question of the King?
5. What was the shepherd's answer to the second question of the King?
6. What was the shepherd's answer to the third question of the King?
7. How did the king express his emotions after being answered his all questions?
8. Why did the shepherd not accept king's offer?
9. How was the Abbot benefited by his shepherd's bold answers?
10. What is the main idea of this ballad?

Exercise 5

Discuss the poem 'The Abbot of Canterbury' as a ballad? Note down your answer in the notebook. Once you have written, compare it with your partner.

Exercise 6

'The Abbot of Canterbury' is an interesting poem that urges the readers not to judge the people and their wisdom on the ground of their appearance and profession.

Work in groups of three. Compose your own poem on the similar theme, using elements of poetry based on three stanzas. Each member of group should compose 1 stanza. After your group has composed the poem, share it with other groups.

Exercise 7

Work in groups of three to enact the given story by playing different roles. Each group should rehearsal at least two times in the class.

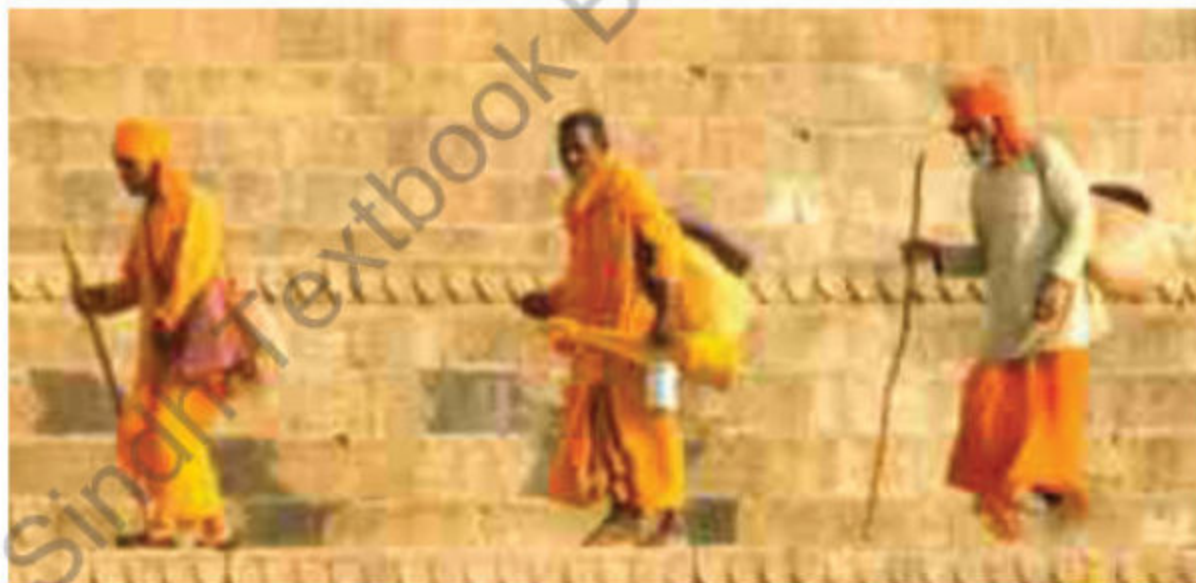
Exercise 8

Work individually and explain the following lines. Write down your work in the notebook and share it with your class fellows after you have completed.

Line No.	Lines
1-4	An ancient storymaintained little right.
5-8	And I'll tell you a story.....fair London town.
9-12	An hundred men.....waited the abbot about.
13-16	'How now, father abbot?against my crown.'
17-20	'My liege', quoth the abbot.....true-gotten gear.'
21-24	'Yes, yes, father abbot.....smitten from thy body.
25-28	'And first,' quoth the kingpenny what I am worth.
29-32	'Secondly, tell me,what I do think.'
33-36	'O, these are hard questions.....answer your grace.'
37-40	'Now three weeks' space toforfeit to me.
41-44	Away rode the abbotan answer devise.
45-48	Then downwards long stone-wall:
49-52	And then an openthey came.
53-56	'The first is to tell him therehe is worth.'
57-60	'The second, to tell him,he does think.'
61-64	'Now cheer up, sir abbot!answer your quarrel.'
65-68	'Nay, frown not, if it hathfair London town.
69-72	'Now horses and serving-men....our father the Pope.'
73-76	'Now welcome, sir abbot"saved shall be.'
77-80	'And first, when thou seest....what I am worth.'
81-84	'For thirty pence our Saviour....penny worse than He.'
85-88	The king he laughed, andwhole world about.'
89-92	'You must rise with the sun you ride it about.'
93-96	The king he laughed, and swore..... what I do think.'
97-100	'Yes, that shall I do, andpardon for him and for me.'
101-104	The king he laughed, write nor read."
105-108	'Four nobles a week, then,from good King John.'

What will I learn?

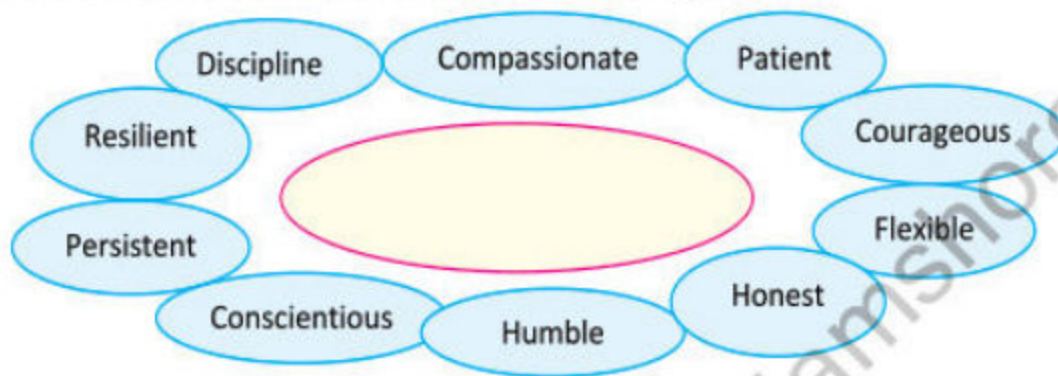
- Use pre-reading strategies to predict content of a text.
- Use while-reading strategies to apply critical thinking, while exploring and interacting with the text.
- Use post-reading strategies to critically evaluate the text and to give a personal opinion.
- Understand to make connections between one's own life, and the characters, events, motives and causes displayed in literature.
- Express personal responses to the given literary text through creativity and imagination.
- Engage in a variety of written assignment paying attention to expressive and effective language.



Khahori means wandering ascetics or those who search. This Sur contains the verses on the wandering life of ascetics who symbolise search of reality by following spiritual path to have glimpses of the reality.

Pre-reading

1. Read the words given in the diagram and guess the theme of the poem.
2. Write the theme in the centre of the diagram.



Selection from Sur Khahori

(Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai)

Mother! I saw those, who have Beloved seen,
One must stay a night with those who with God have been,
Their recognition becomes a raft in this ocean of the world.

3

Khahoris prepared early to depart,
Searching in the rocks, reduced to bones they are,
Giving much trouble to their bodies, they sought their goal.

6

Their faces are dry, on their feet are slippers old and torn,
They traversed that land, where even the knowing ones are lost,
Their secretive ones, talk secrets of that far off land.

9

Where not a trace of birds is seen, fire is lit,
Who save a group of ascetics can kindle it?

11

Those who went to jungle were not misled,
Those on high way were way-laid,
Those who gave up both the worlds, were from ignorance saved.

14

True seekers still exist,
Known only to those who are for spiritual realms,
Having found them, they have built their nests close to them.

17

Translated by Professor Amina Khamisani

Note for teachers: Elicit response to pre-reading questions and accept all the responses. Make sure that all students participate. Next, ask the students to listen and follow the lines as you read the poem aloud. After that, divide the students in groups and randomly call upon each member of group to recite the poem aloud with intonation and appropriate gestures.

Exercise 1

Work in pairs and find out the meaning of the following words by using dictionary. Read the poem carefully and write the contextual meaning against each word. After completing, share your work with your partner.

No.	Words	Contextual Meaning
1	traversed	
2	ascetics	
3	ridge	
4	desolation	
5	grieving	
6	highland	
7	rambling	
8	flicker	

Exercise 2

Read the poem again and encircle the correct option.

1. Khahoris trouble their bodies to attain their _____.
 a. goal
 b. class
 c. earnings
 d. destination
2. Khahoris face severe _____ while achieving their goals.
 a. criticism
 b. conditions
 c. hardships
 d. all of them
3. Khahoris never take their _____ when they have goals.
 a. property
 b. care
 c. followers
 d. none
4. "Khahoris' faces are dry, on their feet are slippers old and torn" shows the _____.
 a. struggle
 b. emotion
 c. hardships
 d. pleasure
5. Khahoris recognition is like _____.
 a. caravan in desert
 b. raft in ocean
 c. guide in mountains
 d. safety in jingle

6. Khahoris can be found even where there is no trace of:
- human beings
 - animals
 - birds
 - cattle
7. In fourth stanza, the word 'save' is used in sense of _____.
- safety
 - preservation
 - together
 - except
8. True seekers can only be known to those who are for _____.
- jungle dwelling
 - deserted abodes
 - mountain peaks
 - spiritual realm

Exercise 3

Work in pairs and read the above selection again. Comprehend it thoroughly and paraphrase it in simple words. After you have completed, share with your partner.

Exercise 4

Read the selection again and answer the following questions.

1. How is *Khahori*'s character depicted by the poet?
2. How do the *Khahoris* experience sleep?
3. Where and why do *Khahoris* spend their days and nights?
4. What does the poet want to say when he says "Where not a trace of birds is seen, fire is lit"?
5. What reward does a *Khahori* get after his hard work?
6. Sur Khahori is the narration of Khahoris' struggle. Elaborate.
7. Which poetic devices have been used in this poetry? Write with the examples.
8. How do you express your emotions on the struggle of your friend or a family member?

Exercise 5

Work in groups of three. Compose your own poem on the theme of Search of Reality, using elements of poetry based on three stanzas. Each member of group should compose 1 stanza. Once your group has composed the poem, exchange it with other groups.

Exercise 6

Work individually and write the central idea of the lines of Sur Khahori in your notebook. Once you have completed, exchange your work with your class fellows.

Exercise 7

Work in pairs and give a critical appreciation of the lines based on the following aspects. Once you have written, compare your work with your partner.

- | | | |
|-------------------|------------|--------------|
| 1. Poetic Diction | 2. Theme | 3. Structure |
| 4. Language | 5. Message | |

Exercise 8

Work individually and identify the poetic devices in the selection. Make a list of them and use them in your sentences. Share your work with your class fellows after you have completed.

Exercise 9

Work individually and explain the following lines. Write down your work in the notebook and share it with your class fellows once you have completed.

Line No.	Lines
1-3	Mother! I saw those, ...raft in this ocean of the world.
4-6	Khahoris preparedthey sought their goal.
7-9	Their faces are dry.....talk secrets of that far off land.
10-11	Where not a traceascetics can kindle it?
12-14	Those who went to jungleignorance saved.
15-17	True seekers stillbuilt their nests close to them.

SECTION-C: Play

What will I learn?

- Use post-reading strategies to critically evaluate the text and give a personal opinion.
- Observe that writers portray these universal emotions through their preferred genre and according to their socio-cultural context.
- Critically analyse literary texts.
- Analyse how writer has used language and style.
- Interpret the literary themes with real life situations, social and cultural norms.
- Express personal responses to the given literary text through creativity and imagination.
- Analyse the given play with respect to various elements.
- Express their personal response to the overall effect of the given literary text.
- Know the elements of drama (plot characters, theme, setting, dialogue).
- Know that the purpose of literature is to entertain, inform and persuade the reader/audience in diverse ways.
- Make connections between one's own life and the characters, events, motives and causes displayed in literature.
- Recognize recurring themes and the existence of universal human emotions across literary works.

Introduction

Play can be defined as a literary work meant for theatrical performance through a particular medium, i.e. stage, screen, or radio. Drama and play are considered the same.

A play is divided into different acts for a better narration of the story and effective structure. Each act is further divided into a number of scenes with different characters and settings.

A play has mainly these elements:

- a plot - an arrangement of incidents of the story
- characters - people, or other beings, around which the story revolves
- dialogue - the conversation between the characters
- setting - time and place where a story is set

At the crux of the play are conflict and resolution. The play's structure follows the trajectory of introduction, the rise of action, climax, fall of action, and conclusion. There are various types of plays such as tragedy, comedy, tragicomedy, melodrama, science fiction, etc.

About 'A Visit to a Small Planet'

Gore Vidal's 'A Visit to a Small Planet' is a science-fiction comedy. It follows the exploits of Kreton, an alien from a distant and technologically more advanced planet, who observes Earth as his hobby. He intends to see the Civil War during 1861; but mistakenly, he lands nearly a century later in Manassas, Virginia. Nevertheless, he decides to stay and starts his own war to have a little fun.

Though the play was written in 1957, it is still relevant. The story and characters are simple. Vidal originally wrote this play as a television script. After its success, he reworked it for the stage. Later, a movie was also made on it. Here only the first act of the play is given with few changes for better performance.

A VISIT TO A SMALL PLANET**Characters in the Play**

1. Kreton
2. Roger Spelding
3. Ellen Spelding
4. Mrs. Spelding
5. John Randolph
6. General Powers
7. Aide

SCENE I

(The room is comfortably balanced between the expensively decorated and homely. ROGER SPELDING is concluding his TV broadcast. He is a middle-aged, unctuous, and resonant. His wife, bored and vague, knits passively while he talks at his desk. Two technicians are on hand, operating the equipment. His daughter, ELLEN, a lively girl of twenty, fidgets as she listens.)

SPELDING:

(Into microphone) ... And so, according to General Powers ... who should know if anyone does ... the flying object which has given rise to so much earth's orbit. It is not, as many believe, a secret weapon of this country. Nor is it a spaceship as certain lunatic elements have suggested. General Powers has assured me that it is highly doubtful there is any form of life on other planets capable of building a spaceship. "If any travelling is to be done in space, we will do it first." And those are his exact words....which winds up another week of news. *(Crosses to pose with wife and daughter)*. This is Roger Spelding, saying good night to Mother and Father America, from my old homestead in Silver Glen, Maryland, close to the warm pulse beat of the nation.

TECHNICIAN:

Good show tonight, Mr. Spelding.

SPELDING:

Thank you.

TECHNICIAN:

Yes sir, you were right on time.

(Spelding nods wearily, his mechanical smile and heartiness suddenly gone.)

MRS. SPELDING: Very nice, dear. Very nice.**TECHNICIAN:**

See you next week, Mr. Spelding.

SPELDING:

Thank you boys.

(Technicians go.)

SPELDING:

Did you like the broadcast, Ellen?

ELLEN:

Of course I did, Daddy.

SPELDING:

Then what did I say?

ELLEN:

Oh, that's not fair.

SPELDING:

It's not very flattering when one's own daughter won't listen to what one says while millions of people...

ELLEN:

I always listen, Daddy, you know that.

MRS. SPELDING: We love your broadcasts, dear. I don't know what we'd do without them.**SPELDING:**

Starve.

ELLEN:

I wonder what's keeping John?

SPELDING:

Certainly not work.

ELLEN: Oh, Daddy, stop it! John works very hard and you know it.

MRS. SPELDING: Yes, he's a perfectly nice boy, Roger. I like him.

SPELDING: I know. I know: He has every virtue except the most important one: he has no get-up-and-go.

ELLEN: Precisely. He doesn't want to get up and he doesn't want to go because he's already where he wants to be on his own farm which is exactly where I'm going to be when we're married.

SPELDING: More thankless than a serpent's tooth is an ungrateful child.

ELLEN: I don't think that's right. Isn't it "More deadly ...?"

SPELDING: Whatever the exact quotation is, I stand by the sentiment.

MRS. SPELDING: Please don't quarrel. It always gives me a headache.

SPELDING: I never quarrel. I merely reason, in my simple way, with Miss Know-it-all here.

ELLEN: Oh, Daddy! Next you'll tell me I should marry for money.

SPELDING: There is nothing wrong with marrying a wealthy man. The horror of it has always eluded me. However, my only wish is that you marry someone hard-working ambitious, a man who'll make his mark in the world. Not a boy who plans to sit on a farm all his life, growing peanuts.

ELLEN: English walnuts.

SPELDING: Will you stop correcting me?

ELLEN: But, Daddy, John grows walnuts...

(John enters, breathlessly.)

JOHN: Come out! Quick! It's coming this way. It's going to land right here!

SPELDING: What's going to land?

JOHN: The spaceship. Look!

SPELDING: Apparently you didn't hear my broadcast. The flying object in question is a meteor not a spaceship.

(John has gone out with Ellen. Spelding and Mrs. Spelding follows.)

MRS. SPELDING: Oh, my! Look! Something is falling! Roger, you don't think it's going to hit the house, do you?

SPELDING: The odds against being hit by a falling object that size are, I should say, roughly, ten million to one.

JOHN: Ten million to one or not it's going to land right here, and it's not falling.

SPELDING: I'm sure it's a meteor.

MRS. SPELDING: Shouldn't we go down to the cellar?

SPELDING: If it's not a meteor, it's an optical illusion ... mass hysteria.

ELLEN: Daddy, it's a real spaceship. I'm sure it is.

SPELDING: Or maybe a weather balloon. Yes, that's what it is. General Powers said only yesterday...

JOHN: It's landing!

SPELDING: I'm going to call the police ... the Army! *(Bolts inside.)*

ELLEN: Oh look how it shines!

JOHN: Here it comes!

MRS. SPELDING: Right in my rose garden!

ELLEN: May be it's a balloon.

JOHN: No, it's a spaceship and right in your own backyard.

ELLEN: What makes it shine so?

JOHN: I don't know but I'm going to find out.

(Runs off towards the light.)

ELLEN: Oh, Darling, don't! John, please! John, John come back!

(Spelding wide-eyed returns.)

MRS. SPELDING: Roger, it's landed right in my rose garden.

SPELDING: I got General Powers. He's coming over. He said they've been watching this thing. They ... they don't know what it is.

ELLEN: You mean it's nothing of ours?

SPELDING: They believe it ... *(Swallows hard)* ... it's from outer space.

ELLEN: And John's down there! Daddy, get a gun or something.

- SPELDING:** Perhaps we'd better leave the house until the army gets here.
- ELLEN:** We can't leave John.
- SPELDING:** I can. *(Peers near-sightedly)* Why, it's not much larger than a car. I'm sure it's some kind of meteor.
- ELLEN:** Meteors are blazing hot.
- SPELDING:** This is a cold one....
- ELLEN:** It's opening The whole side's opening! *(Shouts)* John! Come back! Quick ...
- MRS. SPELDING:** Why, there's a man getting out of it! *(Sighs)* I feel much better already. I'm sure if we ask him, he'll move that thing for us. Roger, you ask him.
- SPELDING:** *(Ominously)* If it's really a man!
- ELLEN:** John's shaking hands with him. *(Calls)* John darling, come on up here ...
- MRS. SPELDING:** And bring your friend ...
- SPELDING:** There's something wrong with the way that creature looks ... if it is a man and not a ... not a monster.
- MRS. SPELDING:** He looks perfectly nice to me.
(John and the visitor appear. The visitor is in his forties, a mild, pleasant-looking man with side-whiskers and dressed in the fashion of 1860. He pauses when he sees the three people, in silence, for a moment. They stare back at him, equally interested.)
- VISITOR:** I seem to've made a mistake. I am sorry. I'd better go back and start over again.
- SPELDING:** My dear sir, you've only just arrived. Come in, come in. I don't need to tell you what a pleasure this is ... Mister ... Mister...
- VISITOR:** Kreton ... This is the wrong costume, isn't it?
- SPELDING:** Wrong for what?
- KRETON:** For the country, and the time.
- SPELDING:** Well, it's a trifle old-fashioned.
- MRS. SPELDING:** But really awfully handsome.
- KRETON:** Thank you.
- MRS. SPELDING:** *(to husband.)* Ask him about moving that thing off my rose bed.
(Spelding leads them all into living room.)

- SPELDING:** Come on in and sit down. You must be tired after your trip.
- KRETON:** Yes, I am a little *(Looks around delightedly)* Oh, it's better than I'd hoped!
- SPELDING:** Better? What's better?
- KRETON:** The house ... That's what you call it? Or is this an apartment?
- SPELDING:** This is a house in the State of Maryland, U.S.A.
- KRETON:** In the late 20th Century! To think this is really the 20th Century. I must sit down a moment and collect myself. The real thing!
(He sits down.)
- ELLEN:** You ... You're not an American, are you?
- KRETON:** What a nice thought! No, I'm not.
- JOHN:** You sound more English.
- KRETON:** Do I? Is my accent very bad?
- JOHN:** No, it's quite good.
- SPELDING:** Where are you from, Mr. Kreton?
- KRETON:** *(Evasively)* Another place.
- SPELDING:** On this Earth, of course!
- KRETON:** No, not on this planet.
- ELLEN:** Are you from Mars?
- KRETON:** Oh dear no, not Mars. There's nobody on Mars ... at least no one I know.
- ELLEN:** I'm sure you're teasing us and this is all some kind of publicity stunt.
- KRETON:** No, I really am from another place.
- SPELDING:** I don't suppose you'd consent to my interviewing you on television?
- KRETON:** I don't think your authorities will like that. They are terribly upset as it is.
- SPELDING:** How do you know?
- KRETON:** Well, I ... pick up things. For instance, I know that in a few minutes a number of people from your army will be here to question me and they ... like you ... are torn by doubt.
- SPELDING:** How extraordinary!

- ELLEN:** Why did you come here?
- KRETON:** Simply a visit to your small planet. I've been studying it for years. In fact, one might say, you people are my hobby. Especially, this period of your development.
- JOHN:** Are you the first person from your ... your planet to travel in space like this?
- KRETON:** Oh my no! Everyone travels who wants to. It's just that no one wants to visit you. I can't think, why. I always have. You'd be surprised what a thorough study I've made. *(Recites)* The planet, Earth, is divided into five continents with a number of large islands. It is mostly water. There is one moon. Civilization is only just beginning....
- SPELDING:** Just beginning! My dear sir, we have had....
- KRETON:** *(Blandly)* You are only in the initial stages, the most fascinating stages as far as I'm concerned ... I do hope I don't sound patronizing.
- ELLEN:** Well, we are very proud.
- KRETON:** I know and that's one of your most endearing primitive traits. Oh, I can't believe I'm here at last! *(General Powers, a vigorous product of the National Guard, and his Aide enter.)*
- POWERS:** All right folks. The place is surrounded by troops. Where is the monster?
- KRETON:** I, my dear General, am the monster.
- POWERS:** What are you dressed up for, a fancy-dress party?
- KRETON:** I'd hoped to be in the costume of the period. As you see I am about a hundred years too late.
- POWERS:** Roger, who is this joker?
- SPELDING:** This is Mr. Kreton ... General Powers. Mr. Kreton arrived in that thing outside. He is from another planet.
- POWERS:** I don't believe it.
- ELLEN:** It's true. We saw him get out of the flying saucer.
- POWERS:** *(To Aide)* Captain, go down and look at the ship. But be careful. Don't touch anything. And don't let anybody else near it. *(Aide goes)* So you're from another planet.

- KRETON:** Yes. My, that's a very smart uniform but I prefer the ones made of metal, the ones you used to wear, you know: with the feathers on top.
- POWERS:** That was five hundred years ago ... Are you sure you're not from the Earth?
- KRETON:** Yes
- POWERS:** Well, I'm not. You've got some pretty tall explaining to do.
- KRETON:** Anything to oblige.
- POWERS:** All right, which planet?
- KRETON:** None that you have ever heard of.
- POWERS:** Where is it?
- KRETON:** You wouldn't know.
- POWERS:** This solar system?
- KRETON:** No.
- POWERS:** Another system?
- KRETON:** Yes.
- POWERS:** Look, Buster, I don't want to play games: I just want to know where you're from. The law requires it.
- KRETON:** It's possible that I could explain it to a mathematician but I'm afraid I couldn't explain it to you, not for another five hundred years and by then of course you'd be dead because you people do die, don't you?
- POWERS:** What?
- KRETON:** Poor fragile butterflies, such brief little moments in the sun.... You see we don't die.
- POWERS:** You'll die all right if it turns out you're a spy or a hostile alien.
- KRETON:** I'm sure you wouldn't be so cruel.
(Aide returns; he looks disturbed.)
- POWERS:** What did you find?
- AIDE:** I'm not sure, General.
- POWERS:** *(Heavily)* Then do your best to describe what the object is like.

- AIDE:** Well, it's elliptical, with a fourteen foot diameter. And it's made of an unknown metal which shines and inside there isn't anything.
- POWERS:** Isn't anything?
- AIDE:** There's nothing inside the ship: No instruments, no food, nothing.
- POWERS:** *(To Kreton)* What did you do with your instrument board?
- KRETON:** With my what? Oh, I don't have one.
- POWERS:** How does the thing travel?
- KRETON:** I don't know.
- POWERS:** You don't know. Now look, Mister, you're in pretty serious trouble. I suggest you do a bit of cooperating. You claim you travelled here from outer space in a machine with no instruments....
- KRETON:** Well, these cars are rather common in my world and I suppose, once upon a time, I must've known the theory on which they operate but I've long since forgotten. After all, General, we're not mechanics, you and I.
- POWERS:** Roger, do you mind if we use your study?
- SPELDING:** Not at all. Not at all, General.
- POWERS:** Mr. Kreton and I are going to have a chat. *(To Aide)* Put in a call to the Chief of Staff.
- AIDE:** Yes, General.
- (Spelding rises, leads Kreton and Powers into next room)*
- SPELDING:** This way, gentlemen.
- (At the door Spelding speaks in a low voice to Powers)*
- I hope I'll be the one to get the story first, Tom.
- POWERS:** There isn't any story. Complete censorship. I'm sorry but this house is under martial law. I've a hunch we're in trouble. *(He shuts the door Spelding turns and re-joins his family).*
- ELLEN:** I think he's wonderful whoever he is.
- MRS. SPELDING:** I wonder how much damage he did to my rose garden....

JOHN: It's sure hard to believe he's really from outer space. No instruments, no nothing ... boy, they must be advanced scientifically.

MRS. SPELDING: Is he spending the night, dear?

SPELDING: What?

MRS. SPELDING: Is he spending the night?

SPELDING: Oh yes, yes, I suppose he will be.

MRS. SPELDING: Then, I'd better go make up the bedroom. He seems perfectly nice to me. I like his whiskers. They're so very ... comforting. Like Grandfather Spelding's.

(She goes.)

SPELDING: *(Bitterly)* I know this story will leak out before I can interview him. I just know it.

ELLEN: What does it mean, we're under martial law?

SPELDING: It means we have to do what General Powers tells us to do.

(He goes to the window as a soldier passes by) See?

JOHN: I wish I'd taken a closer look at that ship when I had the chance.

ELLEN: Perhaps he'll give us a ride in it.

JOHN: Travelling in space! Just like those stories. You know: intergalactic drive stuff.

SPELDING: If he's not an impostor.

ELLEN: I have a feeling he isn't.

JOHN: Well, I better call the family and tell them I'm all right.

(He crosses to telephone by the door which leads into the hall.)

AIDE: I'm sorry, sir, but you can't use the phone.

SPELDING: He certainly can. This is my house....

AIDE: *(Mechanically)* This house is a military reservation until the crisis is over: Order General Powers. I'm sorry.

JOHN: How am I to call home to say where I am?

AIDE: Only General Powers can help you. You're also forbidden to leave this house without permission.

SPELDING: You can't do this!

AIDE: I'm afraid, sir, we've done it.

ELLEN: Isn't it exciting!

SCENE II

A handsomely furnished study, many books and a globe of the world. Kreton sits down compliably beside the globe which he twirls thoughtfully. The door opens and Powers enters.)

POWERS: Are you deliberately trying to confuse me?

KRETON: Not deliberately, no.

POWERS: We have gone over and over this for two hours now and all that you've told me is that you're from another planet in another solar system....

KRETON: In another dimension. I think that's the word you use.

POWERS: In another dimension and you have come here as a tourist.

KRETON: Up to a point, yes. What did you expect?

POWERS: It is my job to guard the security of this country.

KRETON: I'm sure that must be very interesting work.

POWERS: For all I know, you are a spy, sent here by an alien race to study us, preparatory to invasion.

KRETON: Oh, none of my people would dream of invading you.

POWERS: How do I know that's true?

KRETON: You don't, so I suggest you believe me. I should also warn you: I can tell what's inside.

POWERS: What's inside?

KRETON: What's inside your mind?

POWERS: You're a mind reader?

KRETON: I don't really read it. I hear it.

POWERS: What am I thinking?

KRETON: That I am either a lunatic from the earth or a spy from another world.

POWERS: Correct. But then you could've guessed that.
(Frowns) What am I thinking now?

- KRETON:** You're making a picture. Three silver stars. You're pinning them on your shoulder, instead of the two stars you now wear.
- POWERS:** *(Startled)* That's right. I was thinking of my promotion.
- KRETON:** If there's anything I can do to hurry it along, just let me know.
- POWERS:** You can. Tell me why you're here.
- KRETON:** Well, we don't travel much, my people. We used to but since we see everything through special monitors and re-creators, there is no particular need to travel. However, I am a hobbyist. I love to gad about.
- POWERS:** *(Taking notes)* Are you the first to visit us?
- KRETON:** Oh, no! We started visiting you long before there were people on the planet. However, we are seldom noticed on our trips. I'm sorry to say I slipped up, coming in the way I did ... but then this visit was all rather impromptu. *(Laughs)* I am a creature of impulse, I fear.....
(Aide looks in.)
- AIDE:** Chief of Staff on the telephone, General.
- POWERS:** *(Picks up phone).* Hello! Yes, sir. Powers speaking. I'm talking to him now. No, sir. No, sir. No, we can't determine what method of power was used. He won't talk. Yes, sir. I'll hold him here. I've put the house under martial law ... belongs to a friend of mine, Roger Spelding, the TV commentator. Roger Spelding, the TV ... What? Oh, no, I'm sure he won't say anything. Who ... oh, yes, sir. Yes, I realize the importance of it. Yes, I will. Good-bye. *(Hangs up)* The President of the United States wants to know all about you.
- KRETON:** How nice of him! And I want to know all about him. But I do wish you'd let me rest a bit first. Your language is still not familiar to me. I had to learn them all, quite exhausting.

- POWERS:** You speak all our languages?
- KRETON:** Yes, all of them. But then it's easier than you might think since I can see what's inside.
- POWERS:** Speaking of what's inside, we're going to take your ship apart.
- KRETON:** Oh, I wish you wouldn't.
- POWERS:** Security demands it.
- KRETON:** In that case my security demands you leave it alone.
- POWERS:** You plan to stop us?
- KRETON:** I already have ... Listen.
(Far-off shouting. Aide rushes into the study.)
- AIDE:** Something's happened to the ship, General. The door's shut and there's some kind of wall all around it, an invisible wall. We can't get near it.
- KRETON:** I hope there was no one inside.
- POWERS:** *(To Kreton)* How did you do that?
- KRETON:** I couldn't begin to explain. Now if you don't mind, I think we should go in and see our hosts.
(He rises, goes into living room. Powers and Aide look at each other.)
- POWERS:** Don't let him out of your sight.
(Powers picks up phone.)

SCENE III

(Same living room as in Scene I. Kreton is with John and Ellen.)

KRETON: I don't mind curiosity but I really can't permit them to wreck my poor ship.

ELLEN: What do you plan to do, now you're here?

KRETON: Oh, keep busy. I have a project or two ... *(Sighs)* I can't believe you're real.

JOHN: Then, we're all in the same boat.

KRETON: Boat? Oh, yes! Well, I should have come ages ago but I ... I couldn't get away until yesterday.

JOHN: Yesterday? It only took you a day to get here?

KRETON: One of my days, not yours. But then you don't know about time yet.

JOHN: Oh, you mean relativity.

KRETON: No, it's much more involved than that. You won't know about time until ... now let me see if I remember ... no, I don't, but it's about two thousand years.

JOHN: What do we do between now and then?

KRETON: You simply go on the way you are, living your exciting primitive lives ... you have no idea how much fun you're having now.

ELLEN: I hope you'll stay with us while you're here.

KRETON: That's very nice of you. Perhaps I will. Though I'm sure you'll get tired of having a visitor under foot all the time.

ELLEN: Certainly not. And Daddy will be deliriously happy. He can interview you by the hour.

JOHN: What's it like in outer space?

KRETON: Dull.

ELLEN: I should think it would be divine!

(Powers enters.)

KRETON: No, General, it won't work.

POWERS: What won't work?

- KRETON:** Trying to blow up my little force field. You'll just plough up Mrs. Spelding's garden.
(Powers snarls and goes into study)
- ELLEN:** Can you tell what we're all thinking?
- KRETON:** Yes. As a matter of fact, it makes me a bit giddy. Your minds are not at all like ours. You see we control our thoughts while you ... well, it's extraordinary the things you think about!
- ELLEN:** Oh, how awful you can tell everything we think?
- KRETON:** Everything! It's one of the reasons I'm here, to intoxicate myself with your primitive minds ... with the wonderful rawness of your emotions! You have no idea how it excites me! You simply seethe with unlikely emotions.
- ELLEN:** I've never felt so sordid.
- JOHN:** From now on I'm going to think about agriculture.
- SPELDING:** *(Entering)* You would.
- ELLEN:** Daddy!
- KRETON:** No, no. You must go right on thinking about Ellen. Such wonderfully purple thoughts!
- SPELDING:** Now see here, Powers, you're carrying this martial law thing too far...
- POWERS:** Unfortunately, until I have received word from Washington as to the final disposition of this problem, you must obey my orders: no telephone calls, no communication with the outside.
- SPELDING:** This is unsupportable.
- KRETON:** Poor Mr. Spelding! If you like, I shall go. That would solve everything, wouldn't it?
- POWERS:** You're not going anywhere, Mr. Kreton, until I've had my instructions.
- KRETON:** I sincerely doubt if you could stop me. However, I put it up to Mr. Spelding. Shall I go?
- SPELDING:** Yes! *(Powers gestures a warning)* Do stay, I mean, we want you to get a good impression of us ...
- KRETON:** And of course you still want to be the first journalist to interview me. Fair enough. All right, I'll stay on for a while.

- POWERS:** Thank you.
- KRETON:** Don't mention it.
- SPELDING:** General, may I ask our guest a few questions?
- POWERS:** Go right ahead, Roger. I hope you'll do better than I did.
- SPELDING:** Since you read our minds, you probably already know what our fears are.
- KRETON:** I do, yes.
- SPELDING:** We are afraid that you represent a hostile race.
- KRETON:** And I have assured General Powers that my people are not remotely hostile. Except for me, no one is interested in this planet's present stage.
- SPELDING:** Does this mean you might be interested in a later stage?
- KRETON:** I'm not permitted to discuss your future. Of course my friends think me perverse to be interested in a primitive society but there's no accounting for tastes, is there? You are my hobby. I love you. And that's all there is to it.
- POWERS:** So you're just here to look around ... sort of going native.
- KRETON:** What a nice expression! That's it exactly. I am going native.
- POWERS:** (*Grimly*) Well, it is my view that you have been sent here by another civilization for the express purpose of reconnoitring prior to invasion.
- KRETON:** That would be your view! The wonderfully primitive assumption that all strangers are hostile. You're almost too good to be true, General.
- POWERS:** You deny your people intend to make trouble for us?
- KRETON:** I deny it.
- POWERS:** Then, are they interested in establishing communication with us? Trade? That kind of thing?
- KRETON:** We have always had communication with you. As for trade, well, we do not trade ... that is something peculiar only to your social level. (*Quickly*) Which I'm not criticizing! As you know, I approve of everything you do.

- POWERS:** I give up.
- SPELDING:** You have no interest then in ... Well, trying to dominate the earth.
- KRETON:** Oh, yes!
- POWERS:** I thought you just said your people weren't interested in us.
- KRETON:** They're not, but I am.
- POWERS:** You!
- KRETON:** Me ... I mean I. You see I've come here to take charge.
- POWERS:** Of the United States?
- KRETON:** No, of the whole world. I'm sure you'll be much happier and it will be great fun for me. You'll get used to it in no time.
- POWERS:** This is ridiculous. How can one man take over the world?
- KRETON:** *(Gaily)* Wait and see!
- POWERS:** *(To Aide)* Grab him!
- (Powers and Aide rush Kreton but within a foot of him, they stop, stunned.)*
- KRETON:** You can't touch me. That's part of the game. *(He yawns)* Now, if you don't mind, I shall go up to my room for a little lie-down.
- SPELDING:** I'll show you the way.
- KRETON:** That's all right. I know the way. *(Touches his brow)* Such savage thoughts! My head is vibrating like a drum. I feel quite giddy, all of you thinking away. *(He starts to the door; he pauses beside Mrs. Spelding)* No, it's not a dream, dear lady. I shall be here in the morning when you wake up. And now good night, dear, wicked children.... *(He goes out)*

CURTAIN

Exercise 1

Work in pairs and scan the text to write the synonym of the following words contextually. Use them in sentences. After completing, share your work with your partner.

No	Word	Contextual meaning	Sentence
1.	impromptu		
2.	lunatic		
3.	blazing		
4.	giddy		
5.	reconnoitring		
6.	disposition		
7.	primitive		
8.	seethe		
9.	unctuous		
10.	fidgets		
11.	sordid		
12.	resonant		

Exercise 2

Read the statements and encircle the correct option.

- The play takes place in a small suburb in _____.
a. Maryland b. Washington
c. Virginia d. Indiana
- Spelding _____ flying object in space.
a. accepts b. denies
c. doubts d. confirms
- Spelding criticizes John for growing _____.
a. cabbage b. walnuts
c. corn d. peanuts
- Kreton appears to be in his _____.
a. twenties b. thirties
c. forties d. fifties

Note for teacher: When students complete Exercise 1, make pairs and ask them to compare their answers with their partner. Next, elicit answers from the whole class and ask the students to check their work.

5. The impression of Kreton on seeing the inside of the house was_____.
a. disgusted b. delighted
c. callous d. sorrowful
6. The spaceship landed in Mrs. Spelding's_____.
a. rose garden b. petunia bed
c. greenhouse d. vegetable garden
7. Kreton said that the earthmen were his_____.
a. hobby b. ruination
c. hope d. models
8. Kreton mistakenly thought that he had come to earth in the_____.
a. 18th century b. 19th century
c. 20th century d. 21st century
9. The first person who arrived to investigate the spaceship was
a. Powers b. Laurent
c. President of the United States d. neighbour
10. Kreton said people on his planet did not_____.
a. did not fight b. did not speak
c. did not die d. did not love
11. Kreton's space ship was of_____ shape.
a. elliptical b. oval
c. circular d. triangular
12. John could not use the telephone because _____.
a. Kreton had cut communication
b. Speldings did not have any
c. Powers declared martial law
d. Spelding wouldn't give him permission
13. General Powers was thinking about_____.
a. his promotion b. security of the country
c. arrest of Kreton d. murder of the visitor

14. According to Kareton, civilization is just_____.
a. at the ending b. at the beginning
c. full bloom d. creeping
15. The elements of science fiction in this passage are most pronounced in_____.
a. Kreton's supernatural abilities
b. reactions to Kreton
c. Kreton belongs to another breed of human
d. hobbies of Kreton
16. Kreton placed an invisible wall around his spaceship because_____.
a. the army told him to.
b. the army was going to take it apart.
c. the earth's atmosphere was damaging it.
d. his own people had suggested it.
17. Powers accused Kreton of coming to earth_____.
a. 100 years too soon
b. to spread a mysterious disease
c. to discover some natural resources
d. to reconnoitre before an invasion
18. Kreton said John's thoughts about Ellen were_____.
a. black b. red
c. purple d. yellow
19. Kreton considers human civilization_____.
a. modern b. primitive
c. conservative d. rational
20. Kreton intends to take charge of_____.
a. rose garden b. Spelding's house
c. USA d. world

Exercise 3

Work in pairs. Skim through the text. First, write the name of respective character who said the following dialogues in Column B, and write the context of the dialogues in which character had said that particular dialogue in Column C. First one has been done as an example. After completing, share your work with your partner.

Column A (Dialogue)	Column B (character)	Column C In the Context of
Fair enough. All right, I'll stay on for a while.	Kreton	This statement or dialogue is said to Spelding when Spelding instructed him to stay because of General Power's interview.
He has no get-up-and-go.		
I am a hobbyist. I love to gad about.		
But I prefer the ones made of metal, the ones you used to wear, you know: with the feathers on top.		
Poor fragile butterflies, such brief little moments in the sun ...		
I like his whiskers. They're so very ... comforting.		

Exercise 4

Work individually and make a list of the elements of science fiction you find in the play. After you have done, compare your list with your class fellows.

Exercise 5

Work in pairs and arrange the scrambled events in the order of their occurrence in the play by giving the number. After you have completed, share your work with your partner.

No	Events	Order
1.	Kreton arrives on the earth.	
2.	General Powers comes with his Aide.	
3.	Kreton reads the mind of General Powers.	
4.	General Powers orders to grab Kreton.	
5.	John spots a spaceship.	
6.	Kreton announces to take over the world.	
7.	Spelding makes a broadcast and denies any spaceship landing on earth.	
8.	Aide stops Spelding from making a call.	
9.	Kreton reads the minds of John and Ellen.	
10.	General Powers and Kreton have a conversation in the study.	

Exercise 6

Read the text and answer the following questions.

1. What is ironic about Spelding's broadcast at the beginning of the play?
2. Why is Spelding unhappy about the relationship between Ellen and John?
3. Why did Kreton want to visit earth?
4. How is Kreton able to communicate with the people on earth?
5. Describe the reaction of different characters to Kreton's visit?
6. Why is General Powers paranoid about Kreton's visit?
7. What restrictions are imposed on Spelding's family?
8. What extraordinary powers does Kreton possess, and how does he exhibit these powers?
9. Why does Spelding want Kreton to stay?
10. Why did Kreton's friends consider him pervasive?
11. How does Kreton reveal that he does not have any favourable view of earthlings?
12. How does Kreton foil General Power's attempts to confine him?

13. Who is Aide? What is his role in the play?
14. How did Aide describe Kreton's spaceship?
15. Describe the main comic incidents of the play?
16. How is media depicted in the play?
17. The play is a satire on American society. Discuss.
18. How does the playwright expose the inferiority of the present race to that of the future?
19. Describe the arrival of the flying saucer in your own words.
20. How much advanced is the civilization of Kreton than of the Earth?
21. Why can the people of earth not compete with people of Kreton?
22. What type of life do you foresee in the year 5000?
23. What are the literary elements used in "Visit to a Small Planet," and how they enhance the story?
24. Who is your favourite character in this play and why?

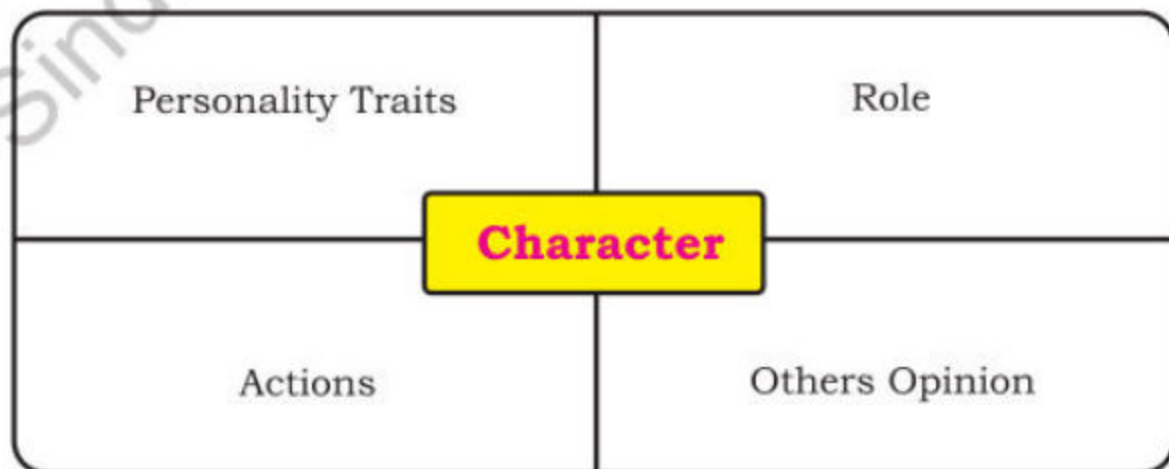
Exercise 7

Suppose an alien visits the Earth from another planet. Work in pairs and prepare a list of your questions that you would ask the alien. Next, prepare the alien's answers. After you have completed, share your work with your class fellows.

Exercise 8

Work individually and sketch the following characters with the help of below given mind map. Once you have completed, share your work with your class fellows.

- | | | |
|-----------------|-------------------|-----------|
| a. Mr. Spelding | b. Mrs. Spelding | c. Ellen |
| d. John | e. General Powers | f. Kreton |



Exercise 9

Work in pairs and compare and contrast between 'life on earth and on Kreton's planet'. After you have done, share your work with your partner.

Exercise 10

Work in pairs and summarise the play in your words. After you have summarised, exchange the work with each other.

Exercise 11

Work in pairs. Read the play again and identify the elements (i.e. plot, character, dialogue, and setting). After you have identified, write their examples from the text in the table given below.

Plot	
Character	
Dialogue	
Setting	

BIOGRAPHIES**Sir Henry Wotton**

Sir Henry Wotton (1568–1639) was an English author, poet, diplomat and politician. He studied at Oxford where he met John Donne who later became a close friend. In 1595, Wotton became secretary to the Earl of Essex, collecting foreign intelligence. He became the ambassador to the court of Venice, and in later years, provost of Eton College. Whilst on a visit to Augsburg in 1604, he wrote a definition of an Ambassador which is now one of his most famous phrases; "An Ambassador is an honest man, sent to lie abroad for the good of his country." Although his works are small in number, they are known for having great poise and polish and his enthusiasm for classical architecture and proportion can be seen to have a large influence on his poetry.

**Edgar Albert Guest**

Edgar Albert Guest (1881 –1959) was born in Birmingham, England but was educated in United States as his family moved there. Owing to his themes and language used in his works, he became known as the People's Poet. His poems often had an inspirational and optimistic view of everyday life. His poetry was read the most during the first half of the 20th century. His first book, 'A Heap O' Livin' became a best-seller. It was followed by similar collections of his optimistic rhymes, Just Folks (1918), Rhythms of Childhood (1924), Life's Highway (1933), and Living the Years (1949).

**Percy Bysshe Shelley**

Percy Bysshe Shelley (1792-1822) was born in Sussex and educated at Eton and University College, Oxford. He was a close friend of Byron and a generous admirer of Keats, whose death moved him to write the great elegy, *Adonais*. His notable works include *Prometheus Unbound*, the *Cenci*, *Lines Written Among the Euganean Hills*, *Ode to the West Wind*, *The Cloud* and many others. His greatest passages have a pure and intense lyrical quality that demands his recognition as a major poet. Like so many English poets, he loved the sea, a love which cost his life for he was drowned when sailing a small boat of Spezzia.

**Douglas Malloch**

Douglas Malloch (1877 -1938) was an American poet, short-story writer and an associate editor of *American Lumberman*, a trade paper in Chicago. He was born in Muskegon, Michigan which was surrounded by forests, logging camps, and lumber yards. This rural setting became the inspiration for his poetry and made him famous as a "Lumberman's poet." He is remembered for writing his master pieces, *i.e.* "Round River Drive" and "Be the Best of Whatever You Are". He was commissioned to write the Michigan State Song.



The Abbot of Canterbury

The poem "The Abbot of Canterbury" is a ballad of unknown poet telling an ancient story. The ballad is a poem or a song narrating a story in short stanzas. Traditional ballads are typically of unknown authorship, having been passed on orally from one generation to other.

King John of England had a reputation of confiscating property from the clergy. This poem tells how King John, covetous of the Abbot of Canterbury's hospitality and popularity, compels him on pain of death to answer three impossible questions. Fortunately, the Abbot's shepherd appears in disguise to substitute in his place, and answers the questions cleverly in riddle fashion. After which, the greedy king rewards the shepherd and spares the Abbot's life.



Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai

Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai (1689-1752) was born at a village near Halla Haveli of present District Matiari, Sindh. His father Syed Habib was one of the prominent figures in the area. Shah Abdul Latif was a pious person and had nothing to do with worldly luxuries. He spent his whole life in worship and austerities. His poetry's collection

"Shah Jo Risalo" is the poetry of love, kindness, brotherhood, peace and love of motherland. Shah Jo Risalo consists of 30 chapters and each chapter is called 'Surr'. The poetry of Shah Latif portrays nature and its signs in a generally clear and enthusiastic way. The impact of his great work on Sindhi literature is so incredible which intoxicated all the writers after his time.

**William Wordsworth**

William Wordsworth (1770-1850) was born in the Lake District England, and educated at Hawkshead Grammar School and St. John's College, Cambridge. After leaving Cambridge, he spent a year in France and was passionately in sympathy with the revolutionaries. In 1793, he published 'Descriptive Sketches' and 'An Evening Walk'. These works show his life-long love of natural beauty. He published Lyrical Ballads in 1798, which contained some of the poems of his friend Coleridge, but was made up otherwise, of poems by Wordsworth. The volume forms one of the great landmarks in the history of English poetry. Wordsworth, as a poet and critic, introduced a new conception of poetic style, insisting that the plain language of common speech was a fit medium for the poet. Again, he insisted that the ordinary events in humble lives were fit subject matter, when viewed by the poetic imagination. A new poetic vision which found a revelation of God in the beauties of nature came into English poetry.

**Amina Khamisani**

Amina Khamisani (1919-2007) was a renowned educationist and writer. She did her M.A English from University of Sindh and Diploma in English Literature from Oxford University, UK. She served as a faculty member of English Department, University of Sindh. Her remarkable work is the translation of Shah Jo Risalo in English.



Altaf Shaikh

Altaf Shaikh is a travelogue writer. He was born on 14th November, 1944 at New Hala, Matiari District Sindh. After completing his early education at Cadet College, Petaro, he acquired a degree in Marine Engineering. Then, he did M.Sc. in Maritime Safety Administration and joined Pakistan National Shipping corporation. He has a unique writing style and has no match in writing travelogues in Sindhi. His more than forty travelogues have been published

among which 'Around The World and A Journey to Thailand' is very famous.



Maupassant

Henri René Albert Guy de Maupassant (1850 – 1893) was a 19th-century French author. He is remembered as a master of the short story. His stories are characterized by economy of style and efficient structure. Many are set during the Franco-Prussian War of the 1870s, describing the futility of. He wrote 300 short stories, six novels, three travel books, and one

volume of verse. His first published story, "Boule de Suif" is often considered his masterpiece. His stories are second only to Shakespeare in their inspiration of movie adaptations. Several of Maupassant's short stories, including "La Peur" and "The Necklace", were adapted as episodes of the television series.



Saadi

Abu-Muhammad Muslih al-Din bin Abdullah Shirazi (1210- 1292), better known by his pen name *Saadi* was a major Persian poet and prose writer of the medieval period. He is famous for the quality of his writings and for the depth of his social and moral thoughts. Saadi is widely recognized as one of the greatest poets of the classical literary tradition, earning him the nickname "The

Master of Speech" among Persian scholars. He has been quoted in the Western traditions as well. His books, *Gulistan* and *Bustan*, are equally recognized around the world. *Bostan* has been ranked as one of the 100 greatest books of all times by *The Guardian*.

E. B. White



Elwyn Brooks White (1899 – 1985) was an American writer. He was the author of several highly popular books for children, including *Stuart Little* (1945), *Charlotte's Web* (1952), and *The Trumpet of the Swan* (1970). In addition, he was a writer and contributing editor to *The New Yorker* magazine, and also a co-author of the English language style guide, *The Elements of Style*. E. B. White published his first

article in *The New Yorker* in 1925. Then, he joined the staff in 1927 and continued to contribute for almost six decades. In the late 1930s, White turned his hand to children's fiction. His first children's book, *Stuart Little*, was published in 1945, and *Charlotte's Web* followed in 1952.

Ralph Waldo Emerson



Ralph Waldo Emerson (1803-1882) was an American essayist, lecturer, poet and philosopher. Emerson wrote most of his important essays as lectures first and then revised them for the printing. His first two collections of essays, *Essays: First Series* (1841) and *Essays: Second Series* (1844), represent the core of his thinking. They include the well-known essays "Self-Reliance", "The Over-Soul", "Circles", "The

Poet", and "Experience." His philosophy is everlasting because it arose from a desire to make things new, to seize life freshly, experience it first hand and use it to build beyond the old. His work has greatly influenced thinkers, writers and poets that followed him.